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LevelUp!

Private Lessons Booking Marketplace

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1. Organisation / Motivation / Executive Summary

1.1 Executive Summary

LevelUp! is a web-based marketplace designed to simplify the process of booking private lessons in Ireland across three key categories:

- Grinds (academic tutoring for Junior Cycle and Leaving Certificate students)
- Sports (including personal training, football coaching, golf, and padel)
- Music (such as guitar, piano, and violin lessons).

The platform addresses a widespread problem in the private lessons sector, where bookings are typically arranged informally through text messages, WhatsApp, or word of mouth. This often results in scheduling conflicts, missed sessions, unclear pricing, and unnecessary administrative workload for both learners and instructors.

LevelUp! provides a structured digital solution that allows learners to

- browse verified instructors
- view real-time availability through an interactive calendar
- book lessons instantly with a confirmation

The platform supports a broad range of learners, including students and parents seeking academic support, as well as individuals booking sports coaching or music lessons. In this document we refer to these as users and learners interchangeably depending on the context.

Instructors (also identified as Coaches, Tutors, Teachers) benefit from automated scheduling, recurring availability management, and a centralised booking system that reduces manual coordination while enabling them to build reputation through ratings and reviews. By supporting both in-person and online sessions, the platform delivers a consistent and reliable booking experience across education, sport, and music services.

Technically, LevelUp! is implemented using the Django [1] architecture and is supported by a relational SQLite database suitable for prototype deployment.

The system integrates the FullCalendar JavaScript library to manage real-time scheduling and the Google Maps Places API to support location handling for in-person sessions. While SQLite is appropriate for development and demonstration purposes, migration to a more scalable database such as PostgreSQL has been identified as a future enhancement for commercial deployment.

The platform follows a sustainable business model based on commission fees from completed bookings and a monthly instructor subscription priced at €8 in year 1 (year 2 - €9, year 3 - €10). The Irish private lessons sector represents a recurring and growing opportunity driven by consistent demand for academic support, skills development, and recreational coaching. LevelUp! therefore represents a practical and scalable digital solution that modernises how private lessons are organised and delivered in Ireland.

1.2 Motivations

Private lessons in Ireland, including academic tutoring, sports coaching, and music tuition, are widely used but are still organised in a surprisingly informal way.

A typical lesson arrangement often begins with a recommendation from a friend, a message in a Facebook group, or a post in a local WhatsApp community. From there, coordinating a lesson involves a series of messages to check availability, confirm a time, and rearrange sessions when conflicts arise. In most cases, there is no central system, no real-time visibility of schedules, and no structured confirmation that a lesson has been successfully secured.

Over time, these small inefficiencies create larger operational problems. Learners and parents may struggle to identify available instructors quickly, while missed messages or double bookings can lead to frustration and uncertainty. For instructors, managing schedules through manual communication becomes increasingly difficult as demand grows. Administrative tasks such as confirming lesson times, tracking availability, and handling cancellations can consume valuable time that could otherwise be spent delivering instruction. This limits the number of learners an instructor can support and makes income planning less predictable.

Primary research conducted during this project provided clear evidence of this operational challenge. Only 12 percent of teachers currently offering private grinds, yet 64 percent expressed an interest in doing so in the future. The most commonly cited barriers were difficulty connecting with learners and the administrative burden associated with managing lesson schedules. These findings highlighted a clear and measurable gap within the private lessons sector. See section 2.7.1.

LevelUp! was developed to address this gap by introducing a structured and reliable booking system tailored specifically to private lessons. Rather than acting solely as a discovery platform, the focus of the project was to solve the practical challenge of organising lessons efficiently. The system enables instant booking, real-time availability management, and automated confirmation, reducing administrative workload for instructors while providing a predictable and convenient experience for learners.

The motivation behind LevelUp! is both practical and commercial. The goal is to modernise how private lessons are organised in Ireland by replacing informal communication with a streamlined digital system capable of supporting reliable lesson scheduling across education, sport, and music services.

1.3 Management Report

1.3.1 Organisational Structure

The organisational structure below represents the team required to develop and operate LevelUp! as a scalable commercial platform. During the development of the prototype, the project was delivered by a two-person founding team who jointly fulfilled multiple roles across technical and business functions. While each team member had primary areas of responsibility, both contributors supported development, testing, documentation, and system design activities throughout the project lifecycle.

The structure therefore reflects both the responsibilities performed during development and the additional specialist roles that would be required if LevelUp! were deployed as a fully operational commercial service. This approach aligns with typical startup development models, where a small founding team manages core responsibilities before expanding into dedicated operational roles.

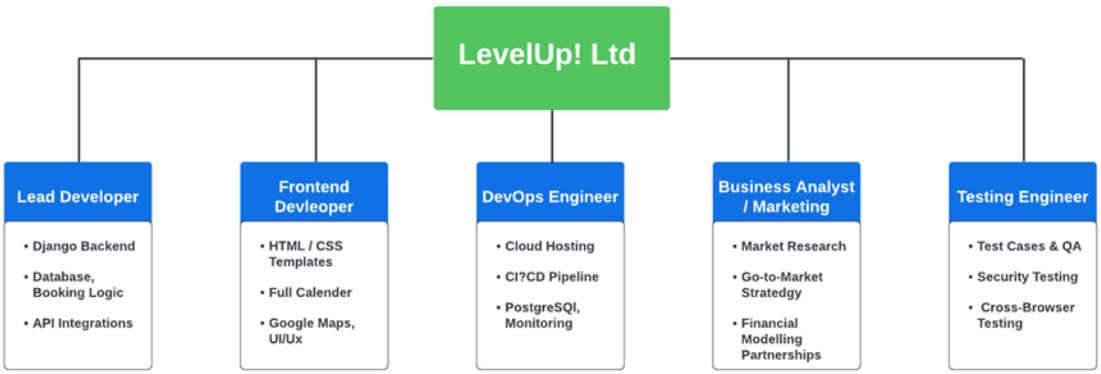

Figure 1: LevelUp! Organisational Structure

1.3.2 Role Allocation During Development

Although the organisational structure includes several specialised roles, the development of the LevelUp! prototype was delivered by a team of two who distributed responsibilities across multiple functional areas. Tasks were assigned based on technical strengths while maintaining collaboration across system design, implementation, testing, and documentation activities throughout the project lifecycle.

During development, the responsibilities associated with each role were carried out as follows:

Lead Developer Responsibilities
- Designed the system architecture and database schema
- Implemented backend functionality, including booking logic and authentication workflows
- Integrated external services such as FullCalendar and Google Maps
- Managed deployment configuration and system reliability

Frontend Development Responsibilities
- Developed user interface components using Django templates, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
- Implemented responsive layouts and consistent visual styling
- Integrated the FullCalendar scheduling interface
- Supported usability testing and interface refinement

DevOps and Deployment Responsibilities
- Researched hosting and deployment environments suitable for web applications
- Configured development environments and managed system settings
- Investigated scalability and deployment considerations for future production use

Business Analysis and Planning Responsibilities
- Conducted market research and analysed user requirements
- Defined the business model and pricing structure
- Developed financial projections and supporting documentation
- Contributed to planning the platform's market positioning

Testing and Quality Assurance Responsibilities
- Developed and executed functional test cases
- Identified and resolved system defects and usability issues
- Performed cross-browser and feature testing
- Documented system limitations and verified system functionality

1.3.3 Development Timeline

The development timeline below outlines the structured progression of the LevelUp! project from initial concept development through to final system delivery. The timeline demonstrates a phased development approach in which major system components were implemented, tested, and refined in a logical sequence.

The project followed a structured development lifecycle beginning with project planning and market research, followed by database and authentication development, implementation of the core booking system, integration of user interface components, and final system testing and documentation.

This phased approach ensured that each component of the platform was completed and validated before progressing to the next stage of development. The timeline reflects continuous development activity across the academic year and demonstrates the systematic delivery of a fully functional working prototype.

The following Gantt chart provides a visual representation of our project plan for LevelUp!.

Figure 2: LevelUp! Gantt Chart

1.3.4 Project Log Files

Detailed development logs for each team member, including task records, progress updates, and project activities, were maintained separately and are available in the links provided below.

Team Member	Link to Log File
Dylan Doyle	[LOG LINK]
James Dalton	[LOG LINK]
Shared Log with Supervisor	[LOG LINK]

1.3.5 Time Descriptions of Key Events

This section provides an overview of the activities performed during the project each week.

Semester 1 – Planning and Core System Development

Weeks 1–2

- Conducted project planning and defined the overall system concept
- Performed market research and developed the initial business case
- Identified system requirements and defined project scope

Weeks 3–4

- Designed the system architecture and database schema
- Developed the entity relationship diagram
- Implemented core Django models including User, CoachProfile, Category, Skill, and Area

Weeks 5–7

- Developed authentication workflows and user account management functionality
- Implemented coach profile management and skill assignment features
- Designed foundational user interface templates and styling

Weeks 8–10

- Implemented the core booking model and slot validation logic
- Developed lesson discovery features including search and category filtering
- Built initial lesson listing and coach profile display functionality

Weeks 11–12

- Completed the initial booking workflow and status management functionality
- Performed mid-term prototype testing and interface refinement
- Delivered the mid-term system submission

Semester 2 – **Feature Expansion, Integration, and Final Delivery**

Weeks 1–3

- Developed the coach dashboard and session slot creation functionality
- Implemented calendar-based scheduling workflows
- Integrated the FullCalendar interface to support real-time availability management

Weeks 4–6

- Implemented recurring session slot generation functionality
- Developed timezone handling for accurate scheduling across sessions
- Performed user interface improvements and styling refinements

Weeks 7–9

- Implemented the atomic booking system to prevent double bookings
- Integrated the Google Maps Places API for location-based lesson booking
- Tested booking reliability under concurrent request conditions

Weeks 10–11

- Developed GDPR-compliant minor profile functionality
- Implemented lesson review and rating features
- Added booking cancellation and notification workflows

Weeks 12–13

- Conducted system testing and bug fixing across core workflows
- Performed cross-browser and user acceptance testing
- Finalised system usability improvements

Week 14

- Completed deployment and hosting configuration research
- Finalised project documentation, diagrams, and supporting materials
- Prepared presentation and final system delivery

2 Business Case

2.1 Description of the Product/Service

LevelUp! is a web-based marketplace designed to simplify the process of booking private lessons in Ireland across three key categories: academic grinds, sports coaching, and music lessons. The platform connects learners and independent instructors through a structured digital system that replaces the informal communication methods commonly used in the private lessons sector, such as messaging applications and word-of-mouth referrals.

The platform operates as a two-sided marketplace in which users can browse instructor profiles, view lesson availability through an interactive calendar, and book sessions instantly with confirmation. Instructors manage their services through a centralised dashboard that allows them to set availability, update lesson information, and monitor bookings. This system provides a consistent and reliable process for arranging lessons across different locations and service types.

LevelUp! supports both in-person and online lessons, enabling flexibility for users and instructors. Parents can book lessons on behalf of minors using managed profiles, while instructors can organise their schedules and maintain professional records of bookings and reviews. Administrators oversee the platform by verifying instructor credentials and maintaining system integrity.

The purpose of LevelUp! is to improve the reliability and efficiency of private lesson booking in Ireland. By introducing real-time scheduling and structured booking workflows, the platform reduces administrative workload for instructors while providing users with a predictable and convenient way to access lessons.

2.2 Value Proposition

Private lessons in Ireland are widely used across education, sport, and music, but the process of organising these lessons remains largely informal. Many bookings are arranged through messaging applications or personal recommendations, requiring repeated communication to confirm availability, reschedule sessions, or manage cancellations. This process can be time-consuming for both learners and instructors and often results in scheduling conflicts or missed bookings.

LevelUp! creates value by introducing a more organised approach to lesson scheduling. By centralising availability and booking within a single system, the platform simplifies the process of arranging lessons and reduces the need for ongoing manual coordination. This allows users to access services more reliably while enabling instructors to manage their schedules more efficiently.

For learners and parents, the platform provides convenience and certainty when arranging lessons. The ability to view availability and confirm bookings quickly reduces uncertainty and saves time. Adults seeking sports coaching or music lessons benefit from a structured and predictable booking process. For instructors, the platform supports more consistent scheduling and improves visibility to potential clients, helping them maintain a steady flow of bookings.

The overall value of LevelUp! lies in improving the reliability and organisation of private lesson booking. By replacing informal communication methods with a structured scheduling process, the platform supports professional service delivery and enables both learners and instructors to manage lessons more efficiently.

We have created a Value Proposition Canvas (VPC) to map the alignment between what our product offers and what our target customers actually need. It comprises two sides: the Value Proposition. describing the product's features, pain relievers, and gain creators; and the Customer Segment, capturing customer jobs, pains, and gains. Refer to Figure 3 and 4 for how we believe LevelUp! serves our two distinct customer segments.

Students & Parents

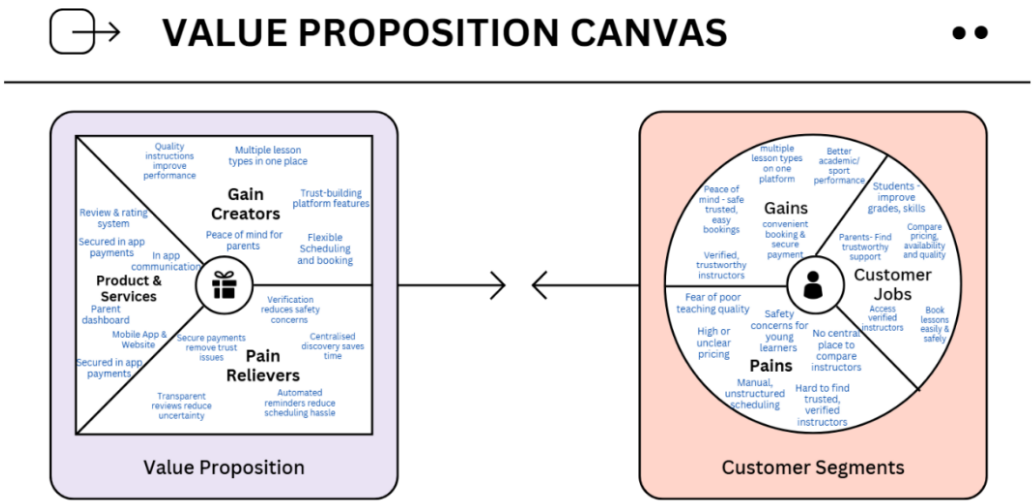

Figure 3: Students & Parents

Teachers & Coaches

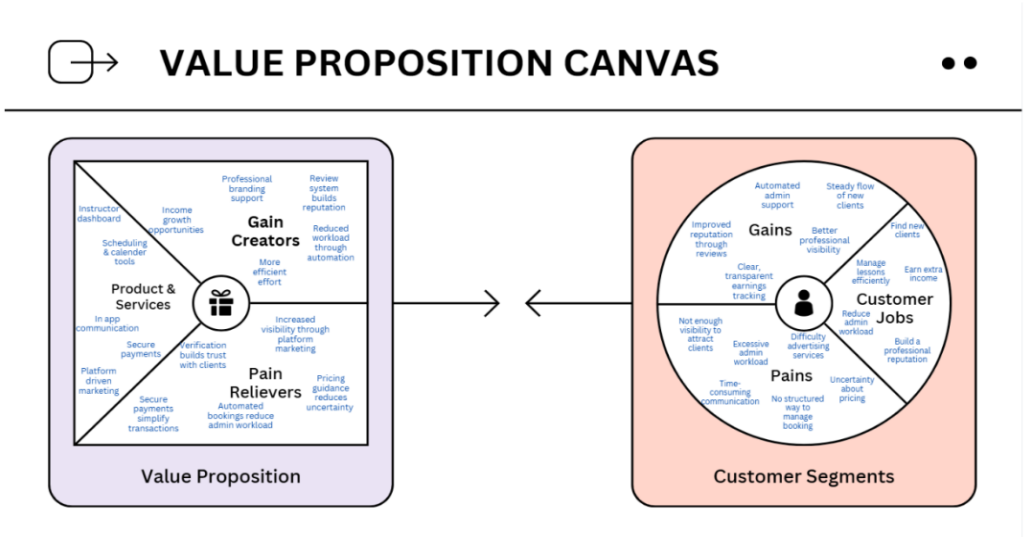

Figure 4: Teachers & Coaches

2.3 Market Analysis

2.3.1 Target Markets

LevelUp! operates within the Irish private lessons and coaching services market, encompassing academic tutoring, sports coaching, and music lessons delivered on a one-to-one basis. This market is characterised by consistent recurring demand and a heavy reliance on informal communication methods such as messaging applications and word-of-mouth referrals. The introduction of a structured digital booking platform presents a clear opportunity to streamline how these services are organised and delivered across Ireland. Supporting statistics and source references for each segment are provided in 2.7 Primary and Secondary Research.

Grinds

Grinds represent the largest and most commercially significant segment. The Leaving Certificate and Junior Certificate examination cycles create an annual and predictable surge in demand for private tuition, with research indicating that over half of Leaving Certificate students avail of grinds each year. This makes private tutoring a mainstream and widely accepted activity in Ireland rather than a niche service, and ensures consistent recurring demand throughout the academic year.

Sports Coaching

Private sports coaching represents a large and growing segment driven by high levels of sports participation across the Irish adult population. Independent coaches delivering personal training, football coaching, golf lessons, and padel are typically self-managed, arranging bookings directly with clients through informal channels. As participation in sport continues to grow, so too does the administrative burden on independent coaches operating without formal scheduling tools.

Music Lessons

Music lessons represent a stable recurring segment, particularly among minors and young adults learning instruments such as guitar, piano, and violin. Lessons are typically delivered weekly over extended periods, creating predictable long-term demand and low churn rates for instructors. Like the other segments, scheduling is largely managed informally, presenting a clear opportunity for a digital solution.

When combined, these three segments represent a significant commercial opportunity within the Irish services economy. Full supporting statistics and source references for each segment are provided in the secondary research section. The fragmented and informal nature of how private lessons are currently arranged, combined with strong recurring demand across all three segments, creates favourable conditions for the introduction of a centralised digital booking platform designed specifically for the Irish market.

2.3.2 Key Market Trends and Drivers

The private lessons and coaching market in Ireland is influenced by several consistent trends that support the long-term viability of a digital scheduling and booking platform. These trends are visible across academic tutoring, sports coaching, and music lessons, and reflect changes in user behaviour, service delivery, and expectations around convenience.

One of the most important trends is the continued growth in demand for personalised services delivered on a flexible schedule. Parents, students, and adult learners increasingly expect services to be available outside standard working hours, particularly during evenings and weekends. This shift toward flexible scheduling increases the complexity of managing bookings manually and creates demand for structured scheduling tools.

Another key trend is the growing number of independent instructors operating as self-managed service providers. Many coaches, tutors, and music teachers operate as sole traders or small businesses, meaning they are responsible for managing their own availability, communication, and client relationships. As their client base grows, the administrative workload associated with managing bookings also increases, making digital platforms more attractive.

Digital adoption is also influencing expectations within the private lessons market. Users are increasingly accustomed to booking services online in sectors such as fitness, healthcare, and transport. As a result, there is growing acceptance of digital booking systems within the education and coaching sectors. This shift creates favourable conditions for the introduction of a platform designed specifically for lesson scheduling.

Finally, the recurring nature of private lessons represents a strong driver of consistent demand. Many services are delivered on a weekly basis over extended periods, creating predictable usage patterns for both instructors and learners. This recurring demand supports the sustainability of a centralised booking system and reduces the risk associated with irregular or seasonal demand.

Together, these trends indicate a stable and expanding market environment in which structured scheduling and booking platforms can provide clear operational benefits for both service providers and users.

2.4 Proposed User Segments

LevelUp! is designed to serve individuals who participate in private lessons across education, sport, and music services. These users require reliable scheduling, clear communication, and efficient booking processes. The platform focuses primarily on independent instructors and individual learners who currently organise lessons through informal communication methods.

The proposed user segments are outlined below.

2.4.1 Students and Parents

Students and parents represent one of the primary user segments for the LevelUp! platform. This group includes Leaving Certificate students preparing for state examinations, college students seeking academic support, and parents arranging lessons on behalf of minors.

These users typically rely on recommendations, messaging applications, or social media to find and book lessons. This process can involve repeated communication to confirm availability and manage scheduling changes. The platform simplifies this process by providing a structured system where availability can be viewed instantly and bookings can be confirmed in a single step.

Students and parents benefit from:

- Faster access to qualified instructors
- Clear visibility of lesson availability
- Reliable booking confirmation
- Reduced time spent coordinating schedules

2.4.2 Adults Seeking Coaching or Lessons

Adults seeking sports coaching or music lessons represent another important user segment. This group includes individuals participating in activities such as personal training, golf coaching, padel lessons, or music tuition.

These users often arrange lessons independently and may require flexible scheduling to fit around work or personal commitments. A structured booking platform allows them to manage appointments more efficiently and maintain consistent participation in training or learning activities.

Adults benefit from:

- Flexible scheduling options
- Convenient lesson management
- Reliable communication with instructors
- Consistent access to coaching services

2.4.3 Independent Instructors

Independent instructors form the supply side of the LevelUp! marketplace. This group includes teachers, sports coaches, and music instructors who operate independently and manage their own client relationships.

These instructors often rely on manual scheduling methods such as messaging or phone calls to coordinate lessons. As demand increases, this approach can become time-consuming and difficult to manage. The platform provides tools that allow instructors to publish availability, accept bookings, and manage schedules more efficiently.

Independent instructors benefit from:

- Reduced administrative workload
- Improved visibility to potential clients
- Structured scheduling management
- More consistent booking activity

2.5 Competitor Analysis

The private lessons market in Ireland is currently fragmented, with most bookings arranged through informal communication channels rather than structured digital platforms. Several services provide partial solutions, but none offer a fully integrated booking system designed specifically for independent instructors operating within the Irish market.

The following competitors represent the most relevant alternatives currently used by learners and instructors.

2.5.1 Tutorful

Tutorful [2] is an online tutoring platform based in the United Kingdom that connects students with tutors across a range of academic subjects. The platform requires tutors to complete a detailed onboarding process, including a comprehensive questionnaire and profile verification process before being approved to offer lessons.

Tutorful primarily supports online tutoring and does not focus on facilitating in-person lessons within Ireland. As a result, the platform is not fully aligned with the needs of local instructors offering face-to-face services such as sports coaching or music lessons.

Strengths:

- Structured tutor onboarding and verification process
- Established platform with recognised brand presence
- Focus on academic tutoring services

Limitations:

- Platform primarily operates within the United Kingdom
- Limited relevance to the Irish education system
- Focus on online tutoring rather than in-person lessons
- Not designed specifically for independent instructors in Ireland

2.5.2 Superprof

Superprof [3] is an international tutoring marketplace that allows instructors to advertise lessons across a wide range of subjects, including academic tutoring, sports coaching, and music lessons. The platform operates as a listing service where learners can browse instructor profiles and contact instructors directly.

Superprof does not provide real-time scheduling or automated booking confirmation. Users must communicate manually with instructors to arrange lesson times and availability.

Strengths:

- Large international network of instructors
- Wide range of lesson categories
- Accessible platform for independent instructors

Limitations:

- Functions primarily as a directory rather than a booking system
- No integrated scheduling or booking functionality
- Heavy reliance on manual communication
- Limited localisation for the Irish market

2.5.3 MusicTeachers

MusicTeachers [4] is an Irish-based website that connects students with music teachers across a range of instruments, including piano, guitar, violin, and voice. The platform allows instructors to create profiles describing their experience, qualifications, and lesson offerings, enabling learners to search for teachers within their local area.

Similar to other directory-style platforms, MusicTeachers.ie primarily functions as a discovery service rather than a full scheduling system. Once a suitable teacher is identified, users typically contact the instructor directly to arrange lesson times and manage ongoing scheduling. While the platform provides visibility for music instructors within Ireland, it does not automate booking management or availability tracking.

Strengths:

- Strong focus on music lessons within the Irish market
- Localised platform designed for Irish instructors
- Simple and accessible listing system for teachers
- Established presence within the music education sector

Limitations:

- Limited to a single lesson category (music lessons only)
- No real-time booking or automated scheduling functionality
- Manual communication required to arrange lesson times
- No integrated calendar-based availability management

2.5.4 Social Media and Messaging Platforms

Social media platforms and messaging applications, such as Facebook groups and WhatsApp, are widely used to advertise and arrange private lessons. These platforms allow instructors to promote services and connect directly with learners within local communities.

Although these channels are commonly used, they rely entirely on manual communication to manage bookings and availability. This approach can lead to scheduling conflicts, missed messages, and increased administrative workload.

Strengths:

- Free and widely accessible
- Familiar to users
- Easy to promote services locally

Limitations:

- No structured booking system
- No automated scheduling or confirmation
- Limited reliability and record keeping
- Increased administrative workload for instructors

These informal methods represent the current standard approach within the private lessons market and highlight the need for a dedicated digital booking platform.

2.6 Competitive Advantage

The competitive advantage of LevelUp! lies in its ability to provide a structured booking system specifically designed for the Irish private lessons market. Many existing solutions in Ireland allow instructors to advertise their services but still rely on manual communication to arrange bookings.

The main advantage that separates LevelUp! from the competitors detailed above is the use of a real-time calendar-based booking functionality. Users can view availability and confirm bookings instantly, reducing scheduling conflicts and improving reliability for both learners and instructors.

Another competitive advantage is the platform's support for multiple lesson categories, including academic tutoring, sports coaching, and music lessons, within a single system. Many competitors focus primarily on grinds, whereas LevelUp! is designed to support a broader range of lessons.

Overall, LevelUp! creates a competitive advantage by replacing informal scheduling methods with a structured digital booking system that improves efficiency for instructors and convenience for learners.

2.7 Primary and Secondary Research

2.7.1 Primary Research

Primary research was conducted to better understand current behaviours and challenges associated with booking private lessons in Ireland. Data was gathered through informal surveys and discussions with students, parents, and teachers, with a particular focus on Leaving Certificate grinds. The aim of this research was to identify how lessons are currently organised and to assess interest in a structured digital booking platform. See Appendix 5.2 for survey results.

The findings highlighted a strong reliance on informal communication methods such as WhatsApp, text messaging, and word-of-mouth referrals. Users reported that arranging lessons often involves multiple messages to confirm availability, which can lead to delays, confusion, and scheduling conflicts. A key insight from the research showed that only 12% of teachers currently offer private grinds, while 64% expressed interest in doing so. The main barriers identified were difficulty connecting with students and the administrative burden of managing bookings and schedules manually.

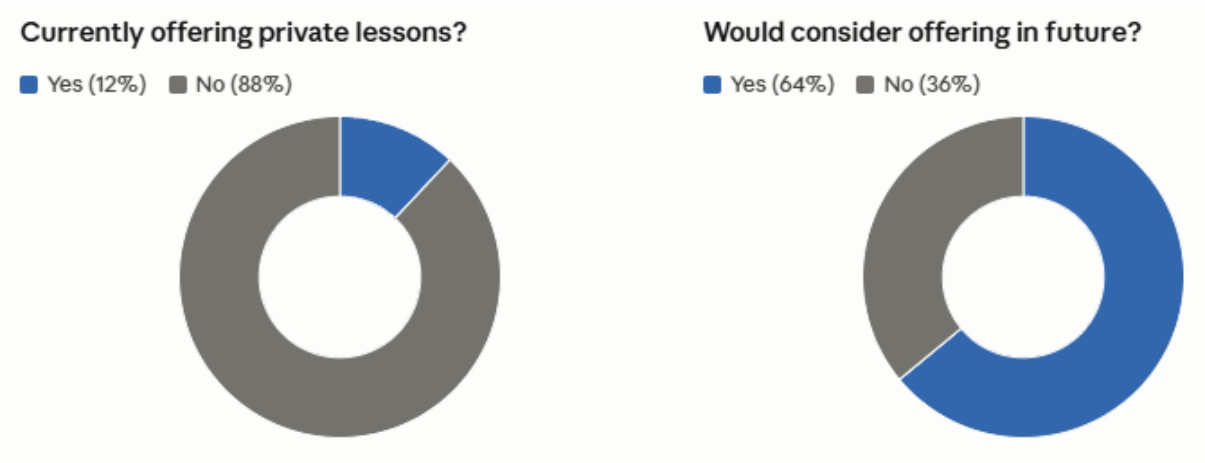

Figure 5: Teacher Participation

These findings directly informed the design of the LevelUp! platform. The emphasis on real-time availability, instant booking confirmation, and automated scheduling functionality was developed specifically to address the inefficiencies identified in the research. Additionally, the inclusion of features such as recurring availability and centralised booking management reflects the needs expressed by instructors during the research process.

2.7.2 Secondary Research

Secondary research was conducted across each of the three market segments to validate the commercial opportunity and support the business case for LevelUp!. The following findings are drawn from published reports, academic research, and industry data relevant to the Irish market.

Grinds

Research published by the Economic and Social Research Institute (ESRI) on shadow education uptake among final year students in Irish secondary schools estimates the Irish private grinds market to be worth approximately €60 million annually on a conservative basis [5]. This figure reflects the scale of private academic tutoring as a standalone market segment within the Irish education sector.

The scale of participation in private grinds was further confirmed by reporting in the Irish Times in September 2024, which found that approximately 55% of Leaving Certificate students avail of private grinds, with a similar figure recorded in Northern Ireland [6]. This places grinds firmly in the mainstream of Irish educational experience rather than as a niche or premium-only service, and ensures a large, consistent, and annually recurring pool of potential students for the platform.

Sports Coaching

Population and participation data for the Irish sports market was sourced from two reports published by official bodies. According to the Central Statistics Office Population and Migration Estimates for April 2024, Ireland's adult population stands at approximately 4.15 million [7]. The Irish Sports Monitor 2024 Summary Report, published by Sport Ireland, reports that 49% of Irish adults participate regularly in sport, representing approximately 2,033,500 active adult participants

nationwide [8]. This large participation base represents the addressable pool of potential students and bookers for sports coaching services on LevelUp!

On the supply side, Sport Ireland's Coaching Report 2024 identifies approximately 268,000 active coaches in Ireland across all sports. Of these, roughly 16% are paid coaches rather than volunteers, representing approximately 42,880 paid coaches who actively earn income from coaching and could potentially list their services on a platform such as LevelUp! [9]. This supply-side figure is particularly significant as it indicates a large base of independent coaches currently operating without dedicated digital booking infrastructure.

Golf represents a notable subsector of the Irish sports coaching market. A report published by MyGolfGroup Consulting in 2025, drawing on Golf Ireland's Economic Impact Report, found that golf in Ireland generated €717 million in direct Gross Value Added, supported 15,600 jobs, and accounted for €703 million in consumer spending in 2023 alone [10]. Golf accounts for 14% of all sport-related spending in Ireland, highlighting the commercial scale of this single activity and demonstrating strong demand for individual golf lessons and coaching services.

Music Lessons

Precise market size data for private music tuition in Ireland is not readily available through published sources. Based on the volume of independent music teachers operating across Ireland and typical pricing for weekly lessons, the Irish private music lessons market is conservatively estimated at approximately €10 million annually. While smaller than the grinds and sports segments, music lessons demonstrate highly predictable demand, with students typically committing to weekly sessions over extended periods of months or years, creating stable and long-term revenue potential for coaches on the platform.

2.8 Revenue Streams

LevelUp! generates revenue from booking transaction-based fees and subscription services. The model reflects a typical marketplace structure in which revenue grows alongside platform usage and booking activity.

Subscriptions - Instructors (Teachers and Coaches) will be offered subscription plans (€8 in year 1, €9 in year 2, €10 in year 3) with the use of promotion codes and referral rewards to encourage initial sign up to the service. Premium subscriptions can be introduced at a later stage to provide additional benefits and promotional features such as advertisement and featured listing options, allowing instructors to increase their visibility during periods of high demand.

Projected Subscription revenue:

Year 1: €3,200

Year 2: €33,120

Year 3: €85,210

Booking Fees - A fixed fee of €2 will be applied to completed bookings made by students or parents.

Projected Booking Fee revenue:

- Year 1: €4,760
- Year 2: €39,680
- Year 3: €92,328

2.9 Pricing Model

The decision regarding which pricing model to adopt for LevelUp! was a critical consideration as it directly influences customer adoption, revenue generation, and long-term sustainability. The chosen pricing model for LevelUp! is a subscription-based and booking transaction-based marketplace model. This approach allows the platform to generate revenue through both recurring subscription fees and individual booking fees, while maintaining low entry barriers for users.

The platform is free for students and parents who wish to sign up to browse for lessons, ensuring that users can access the service without an initial upfront cost. This decision supports early adoption and encourages growth in the number of users on the platform. Revenue is generated when a booking is completed through the application, with a fixed fee of €2 applies to each successful booking by the booker. This structure ensures that revenue is directly linked to platform usage and allows the business to scale naturally as booking activity increases.

In addition to booking fees, instructors using the platform are required to pay a monthly subscription fee of €8 in year 1, €9 in year 2, €10 in year 3. This subscription provides access to core platform functionality, including the ability to publish lesson availability, manage bookings, and maintain a professional profile.

A further advantage of this pricing model is its flexibility for future development. As the platform grows, additional subscription tiers may be introduced to provide enhanced features. These optional upgrades would allow instructors to expand their reach while providing the platform with additional revenue opportunities.

2.10 Financial Requirements

The financial requirements for LevelUp! reflect the resources needed to transition the platform from a functional prototype to a fully operational service. As an early-stage digital platform, the primary financial needs relate to technology infrastructure, marketing, legal compliance, and ongoing system development. These requirements are necessary to ensure reliable service delivery, user acquisition, and regulatory compliance during the initial growth period.

In the first year of operation, the business is expected to operate at a financial loss while investing in platform development and market entry activities. To support operations during this period, LevelUp! will require initial funding through a combination of founder investment and external financing.

The primary source of initial funding will be an external investor contribution of €50,000, which will provide the core capital required to support early-stage operations and platform development. In addition to this investment, the founders will contribute €10,000 of personal funding to

demonstrate financial commitment to the business. The business also plans to secure a bank loan of €20,000 to provide additional working capital during the first year of operation.

Revenue generation for LevelUp! is expected to begin in month 6 (See Year 1 Financial Plan in 2.12), marking the transition from initial development to early commercial operation. As user adoption increases and the number of instructors on the platform grows, revenue is projected to expand steadily, reaching approximately €19,924 by month 36.

It is intended that the bank loan will be repaid from working capital within the two years following receipt of the loan, while the initial external investor will be repaid at the end of year 3, once the business reaches a stable and sustainable financial position.

Based on the financial forecast, LevelUp! is expected to achieve financial stability over time as the number of instructors and users increases. While the business is projected to incur losses in the early stages, revenue growth from subscription fees and booking commissions is expected to support long-term sustainability. The financial requirements outlined in this section therefore represent a realistic investment in the development and scaling of the platform as it moves toward commercial deployment.

2.11 Cost Structure

The cost structure for LevelUp! reflects the ongoing expenses required to operate and maintain the platform as it transitions from a prototype to a commercially deployable service. These costs relate primarily to salaries, marketing, infrastructure, and regulatory compliance.

Founder Salaries

The salaries cost for LevelUp! relates to the salaries of the two founders, who are responsible for the development, management, and administration of the platform. The founders will carry out the roles of software development, financial management, administration, and marketing during the initial stages of the business. This approach allows the company to operate efficiently without the need for additional employees during early operations.

External Marketing

External Marketing expenditure is necessary to promote the platform and attract both instructors and students to the service. Digital marketing will be the primary method used to reach users, including social media advertising and targeted online campaigns. Marketing costs are expected to increase as the platform grows its user base.

Insurance

Business insurance is required to protect the company against operational risks and liabilities.

Office Equipment and Services

Office equipment and services are required to support the daily running of the business. These costs include the purchase of laptops, broadband, mobile phones and general office-related expenses.

Computing Services and Infrastructure

The platform relies on cloud-based computing services and software infrastructure to operate reliably and securely. These services support system hosting, data storage, and application performance. As the number of users increases, these costs may grow in line with platform usage. These costs include cloud hosting and computing services, domain registration and web services, software licences and development tools.

Fee Processing and Bank Charges

Payment processing costs are incurred whenever a booking transaction is completed through the platform. These charges are applied by payment providers and financial institutions and are directly linked to platform usage.

Legal, Tax, and Consultancy

Legal and regulatory compliance is essential for a platform that processes user data, particularly when supporting bookings involving minors. Professional consultancy services are required for setting up a company and to ensure compliance with taxation regulations, data protection laws, and general business governance requirements.

2.12 Three-Year Financial Projection

2.12.1 Overview

We have prepared a financial plan (refer to Figures 6 to 9) that details LevelUp!'s projected income, expenditure, and cash position over a three-year period, providing an overview of the platform's path from initial investment through to operational sustainability.

2.12.2 Link to Financial Plan

Our financial plan is documented in Excel format here: LINK

2.12.3 Financial Plan Commentary

The LevelUp! plan is funded through a combination of investor capital (€50,000), a bank loan (€20,000), and founder buy-in (€10,000), totalling €80,000 in initial investment to support platform development and early-stage operations.

Revenue is generated through two primary streams — subscription fees from tutors and coaches, and booking transaction fees — both of which are projected to grow significantly as the platform scales its user base. Total operating revenue is forecast to increase from €7,960 in Year 1 to €177,538 in Year 3, reflecting anticipated growth in platform adoption and tutor registrations.

LEVELUP!				
FINANCIAL PLAN - YEAR 1 TO YEAR 3				
INVESTMENT INCOME	**YEAR 1**	**YEAR 2**	**YEAR 3**	**3 Yr Forecast**
Investor	€ 50,000	€ -	€ -	€ 50,000
Bank Loan	€ 20,000	€ -	€ -	€ 20,000
Founder Buy-In	€ 10,000	€ -	€ -	€ 10,000
TOTALS	**€ 80,000**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ 80,000**
OPERATING REVENUE	**YEAR 1**	**YEAR 2**	**YEAR 3**	
Subcription Fees	€ 3,200	€ 33,120	€ 85,210	€ 121,530
Booking Transaction Fees	€ 4,760	€ 39,680	€ 92,328	€ 136,768
TOTAL REVENUE	**€ 7,960**	**€ 72,800**	**€ 177,538**	**€ 258,298**
MONTHLY EXPENSES	**YEAR 1**	**YEAR 2**	**YEAR 3**	**3 Yr Forecast**
Founder Salary 1 - Developer, Finance, Admin, & Mark	€ 20,000	€ 24,000	€ 33,600	€ 77,600
Founder Salary 2 - Developer, Finance, Admin, & Mark	€ 20,000	€ 24,000	€ 33,600	€ 77,600
External Marketing	€ 8,500	€ 12,000	€ 12,000	€ 32,500
Insurance	€ 1,800	€ 1,800	€ 1,800	€ 5,400
Broadband/mobile phones/office equipment etc.	€ 6,200	€ 4,200	€ 4,200	€ 14,600
Computing Services/Cloud/Domain/Licences	€ 3,600	€ 6,000	€ 6,000	€ 15,600
Fee Processing & Bank Charges	€ 478	€ 4,368	€ 10,652	€ 15,498
Company Set Up, Legal & Tax Consultants	€ 5,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 9,000
TOTAL MONTHLY EXPENSES	**€ 65,578**	**€ 78,368**	**€ 103,852**	**€ 247,798**
Loan Repayments	€ -	€ 10,000	€ 10,000	€ 20,000
Repay Initial Investment	€ -	€ -	€ 50,000	€ 50,000
OVERVIEW	**YEAR 1**	**YEAR 2**	**YEAR 3**	**3 Yr Forecast**
INVESTMENTS & LOANS REPAYMENTS	€ 80,000	-€10,000	-€60,000	€ 10,000
CASH INCOME	€ 7,960	€72,800	€177,538	€ 258,298
CASH OPERATING OUTGOINGS	€ (65,578)	-€78,368	-€103,852	-€247,798
BANK BALANCE	€102,382	€86,814	€100,500	€ 289,697
NET INCOME & EXPENSE ACCOUNT	**€ (57,618)**	**-€5,568**	**€73,686**	**€ 10,500**
CUMULATIVE INCOME & EXPENSES	€ (57,618)	-€63,186	€10,500	€10,500

Figure 6: 3 Year Forecast Summary

LEVELUP!													
FINANCIAL PLAN - YEAR 1													
INVESTMENT INCOME	**January**	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**	**Year 1**
Investor	€ 50,000	€ -	€ -	€ -		€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 50,000
Bank Loan	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 20,000	€ 20,000
Founder Buy-In	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 10,000	€ -	€ -	€ 10,000
TOTALS	**€ 50,000**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ 10,000**	**€ -**	**€ 20,000**	**€ 80,000**
OPERATING REVENUE	**January**	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**	**Year 1**
Subscription Numbers - Tutors									*25*	*40*	*50*	*80*	
Booking Numbers - Grinds Students									*200*	*320*	*400*	*640*	
Subscription Numbers - Coaches						*10*	*25*	*25*	*30*	*35*	*40*	*40*	
Booking Numbers - Receiving Coaching						*40*	*100*	*100*	*120*	*140*	*160*	*160*	
Total Instructor Users						*10*	*25*	*25*	*55*	*75*	*90*	*120*	
Total Student Bookings						*40*	*100*	*100*	*320*	*460*	*560*	*800*	
Subcription Fees	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 80	€ 200	€ 200	€ 440	€ 600	€ 720	€ 960	€ 3,200
Booking Transaction Fees	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 80	€ 200	€ 200	€ 640	€ 920	€ 1,120	€ 1,600	€ 4,760
TOTAL REVENUE	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ -**	**€ 160**	**€ 400**	**€ 400**	**€ 1,080**	**€ 1,520**	**€ 1,840**	**€ 2,560**	**€ 7,960**
MONTHLY EXPENSES	**January**	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**	**Year 1**
Salary 1 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 20,000
Salary 2 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 1,667	€ 20,000
External Marketing				€ 500	€ 500	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,500	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 8,500
Insurance	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 1,800
Broadband/mobile phones/ laptops, office etc.	€ 2,350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 6,200
Computing Services/Cloud/Domain/Licences	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 300	€ 3,600
Fee Processing & Bank Charges	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 10	€ 24	€ 24	€ 65	€ 91	€ 110	€ 154	€ 478
Company Set Up, Legal & Tax Consultants	€ 1,000	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 2,000	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 2,000	€ 5,000
TOTAL MONTHLY EXPENSES	**€ 7,133**	**€ 4,133**	**€ 4,133**	**€ 4,633**	**€ 6,633**	**€ 5,143**	**€ 5,157**	**€ 5,657**	**€ 5,198**	**€ 5,225**	**€ 5,244**	**€ 7,287**	**€ 65,578**
Loan Repayments	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
BURN RATE	-€7,133	-€4,133	-€4,133	-€4,633	-€6,633	-€4,983	-€4,757	-€5,257	-€4,118	-€3,705	-€3,404	-€4,727	
RUNWAY IN MONTHS	6	9	8	6	4	4	3	2	1	3	2	5	
OVERVIEW	**January**	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**	**Year 1**
INVESTMENTS & LOANS RECEIPTS	€50,000	€0	€0	€0	€0	€0	€0	€0	€0	€10,000	€0	€20,000	€80,000
CASH INCOME	€0	€0	€0	€0	€0	€160	€400	€400	€1,080	€1,520	€1,840	€2,560	€7,960
CASH OPERATING OUTGOINGS	-€7,133	-€4,133	-€4,133	-€4,633	-€6,633	-€5,143	-€5,157	-€5,657	-€5,198	-€5,225	-€5,244	-€7,287	€ (65,578)
BANK BALANCE	**€ 42,867**	**€ 38,733**	**€34,600**	**€29,967**	**€23,333**	**€18,350**	**€13,593**	**€8,336**	**€4,218**	**€10,513**	**€7,109**	**€22,382**	**€22,382**
NET INCOME & EXPENSE ACCOUNT	**-€7,133**	**-€4,133**	**-€4,133**	**-€4,633**	**-€6,633**	**-€4,983**	**-€4,757**	**-€5,257**	**-€4,118**	**-€3,705**	**-€3,404**	**-€4,727**	**-€57,618**
CUMULATIVE INCOME & EXPENSES	-€7,133	-€11,267	-€15,400	-€20,033	-€26,667	-€31,650	-€36,407	-€41,664	-€45,782	-€49,487	-€52,891	-€57,618	-€57,618

Figure 7: Year 1 Financial Plan

LEVELUP!
FINANCIAL PLAN -YEAR 2

INVESTMENT INCOME	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 2
Investor	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
Bank Loan	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
Founder Buy-In	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
TOTALS	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
OPERATING REVENUE	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 2
Expected Growth in tutors	20%	20%	30%	30%	25%	-30%			25%	10%	10%	10%	
Subscription Numbers - Tutors	96	115	150	195	244	171	171	171	214	235	259	285	
Booking Numbers - Grinds Students	768	920	1,200	1,560	1,952	0	0	0	1,712	1,880	2,072	2,280	
Expected Growth in coaches	25%	15%	15%	20%	20%	30%	20%	10%	-5%	-5%	-5%	-5%	
Subscription Numbers - Coaches	50	58	67	80	96	125	150	165	157	149	142	135	
Booking Numbers - Receiving Coaching	200	232	268	320	384	500	600	660	628	596	568	540	
Total Instructor Users	146	173	217	275	340	296	321	336	371	384	401	420	
Total Student Bookings	968	1,152	1,468	1,880	2,336	500	600	660	2,340	2,476	2,640	2,820	
Subcription Fees	€ 1,314	€ 1,557	€ 1,953	€ 2,475	€ 3,060	€ 2,664	€ 2,889	€ 3,024	€ 3,339	€ 3,456	€ 3,609	€ 3,780	€ 33,120
Booking Transaction Fees	€ 1,936	€ 2,304	€ 2,936	€ 3,760	€ 4,672	€ 1,000	€ 1,200	€ 1,320	€ 4,680	€ 4,952	€ 5,280	€ 5,640	€ 39,680
TOTAL REVENUE	€ 3,250	€ 3,861	€ 4,889	€ 6,235	€ 7,732	€ 3,664	€ 4,089	€ 4,344	€ 8,019	€ 8,408	€ 8,889	€ 9,420	€ 72,800
MONTHLY EXPENSES	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 2
Salary 1 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 24,000
Salary 2 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 2,000	€ 24,000
External Marketing	€ 1,500	€ 1,500	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 500	€ 500	€ 1,000	€ 12,000
Insurance	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 1,800
Broadband/mobile phones/office etc.	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 4,200
Computing Services/Cloud/Domain/Licences	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 6,000
Fee Processing & Bank Charges	€ 195	€ 232	€ 293	€ 374	€ 464	€ 220	€ 245	€ 261	€ 481	€ 504	€ 533	€ 565	€ 4,368
Company Set Up, Legal & Tax Consultants	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 2,000	€ 2,000
TOTAL MONTHLY EXPENSES	€ 6,695	€ 6,732	€ 6,293	€ 6,374	€ 6,464	€ 6,220	€ 6,245	€ 6,261	€ 6,481	€ 6,004	€ 6,033	€ 8,565	€ 78,368
Loan Repayments	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 10,000
BURN RATE	-€4,278	-€3,704	-€2,238	-€972	€435	-€3,389	-€2,990	-€2,750	€705	€1,570	€2,022	€ 21	
RUNWAY IN MONTHS	4	4	5	12	CASH POSITIVE	2	2	1	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	
OVERVIEW	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 2
INVESTMENTS & LOANS REPAYMENTS	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€10,000
CASH INCOME	€3,250	€3,861	€4,889	€6,235	€7,732	€3,664	€4,089	€4,344	€8,019	€8,408	€8,889	€9,420	€72,800
CASH OPERATING OUTGOINGS	-€6,695	-€6,732	-€6,293	-€6,374	-€6,464	-€6,220	-€6,245	-€6,261	-€6,481	-€6,004	-€6,033	-€8,565	-€78,368
BANK BALANCE	**€18,104**	**€14,400**	**€12,162**	**€11,190**	**€11,625**	**€8,236**	**€5,246**	**€2,496**	**€3,200**	**€4,771**	**€6,793**	**€6,814**	**€6,814**
NET INCOME & EXPENSE ACCOUNT	**-€3,445**	**-€2,871**	**-€1,404**	**-€139**	**€1,268**	**-€2,556**	**-€2,156**	**-€1,917**	**€1,538**	**€2,404**	**€2,856**	**€855**	**-€5,568**
CUMULATIVE INCOME & EXPENSES	-€61,063	-€63,933	-€65,338	-€65,477	-€64,209	-€66,764	-€68,921	-€70,837	-€69,300	-€66,896	-€64,040	-€63,186	-€63,186

Figure 8: Year 2 Financial Plan

LEVELUP!
FINANCIAL PLAN - YEAR 3

INVESTMENT INCOME	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 3
Investor	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
Bank Loan	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
Founder Buy-In	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
TOTALS	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -
OPERATING REVENUE	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 3
Expected Growth in tutors	10%	10%	15%	30%	20%	-30%	0%	0%	10%	10%	5%	5%	
Subscription Numbers - Tutors	314	345	397	516	619	433	433	433	476	524	550	578	
Booking Numbers - Grinds Students	2,512	2,760	3,176	4,128	4,952	0	0	0	3,808	4,192	4,400	4,624	
Expected Growth in coaches	20%	10%	5%	5%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	-5%	-5%	-5%	
Subscription Numbers - Coaches	162	178	187	196	216	238	262	288	317	301	286	272	
Bookings Numbers - Receiving Coaching	648	712	748	784	864	952	1,048	1,152	1,268	1,204	1,144	1,088	
Total Instructor Users	476	523	584	712	835	671	695	721	793	825	836	850	
Total Student Bookings	3,160	3,472	3,924	4,912	5,816	952	1,048	1,152	5,076	5,396	5,544	5,712	
Subcription Fees	€ 4,760	€ 5,230	€ 5,840	€ 7,120	€ 8,350	€ 6,710	€ 6,950	€ 7,210	€ 7,930	€ 8,250	€ 8,360	€ 8,500	€ 85,210
Transaction Fees	€ 6,320	€ 6,944	€ 7,848	€ 9,824	€ 11,632	€ 1,904	€ 2,096	€ 2,304	€ 10,152	€ 10,792	€ 11,088	€ 11,424	€ 92,328
TOTAL REVENUE	€ 11,080	€ 12,174	€ 13,688	€ 16,944	€ 19,982	€ 8,614	€ 9,046	€ 9,514	€ 18,082	€ 19,042	€ 19,448	€ 19,924	€ 177,538
MONTHLY EXPENSES	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 3
Salary 1 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 33,600
Salary 2 - Developer, Finance, Admin & Marketing	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 2,800	€ 33,600
External Marketing	€ 1,500	€ 1,500	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 1,000	€ 500	€ 500	€ 1,000	€ 12,000
Insurance	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 150	€ 1,800
Broadband/mobile phones/office etc.	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 350	€ 4,200
Computing Services/Cloud/Domain/Licences	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 500	€ 6,000
Fee Processing & Bank Charges	€ 665	€ 730	€ 821	€ 1,017	€ 1,199	€ 517	€ 543	€ 571	€ 1,085	€ 1,143	€ 1,167	€ 1,195	€ 10,652
Company Set Up, Legal & Tax Consultants	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ -	€ 2,000	€ 2,000
TOTAL MONTHLY EXPENSES	€ 8,765	€ 8,830	€ 8,421	€ 8,617	€ 8,799	€ 8,117	€ 8,143	€ 8,171	€ 8,685	€ 8,243	€ 8,267	€ 10,795	€ 103,852
Loan Repayments	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 833	€ 10,000
Repay Initial Investment												€ 50,000	€ 50,000
BURN RATE	€ 1,482	€ 2,510	€ 4,433	€ 7,494	€ 10,350	€ (336)	€ 70	€ 510	€ 8,564	€ 9,966	€ 10,348	€ 8,295	
RUNWAY IN MONTHS	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	97	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	CASH POSITIVE	
OVERVIEW	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Year 3
INVESTMENTS & LOANS REPAYMENTS	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€833	-€50,833	-€60,000
CASH INCOME	€11,080	€12,174	€13,688	€16,944	€19,982	€8,614	€9,046	€9,514	€18,082	€19,042	€19,448	€19,924	€177,538
CASH OPERATING OUTGOINGS	-€8,765	-€8,830	-€8,421	-€8,617	-€8,799	-€8,117	-€8,143	-€8,171	-€8,685	-€8,243	-€8,267	-€10,795	-€103,852
BANK BALANCE	**€8,296**	**€10,806**	**€15,240**	**€22,734**	**€33,084**	**€32,747**	**€32,817**	**€33,327**	**€41,891**	**€51,857**	**€62,205**	**€20,500**	**€20,500**
NET INCOME & EXPENSE ACCOUNT	**€2,315**	**€3,344**	**€5,267**	**€8,327**	**€11,183**	**€497**	**€903**	**€1,343**	**€9,397**	**€10,799**	**€11,181**	**€9,129**	**€73,686**
CUMULATIVE INCOME & EXPENSES	-€60,870	-€57,527	-€52,260	-€43,933	-€32,750	-€32,253	-€31,349	-€30,006	-€20,609	-€9,810	€1,372	€10,500	€10,500

Figure 9: Year 3 Financial Plan

2.13 Business Model Canvas

The Business Model Canvas below provides a structured overview of how LevelUp! creates, delivers, and captures value as a private lessons booking marketplace. Developed using the Osterwalder framework, it outlines the nine core components of our platform's business model across three dimensions: infrastructure, offering, and viability.

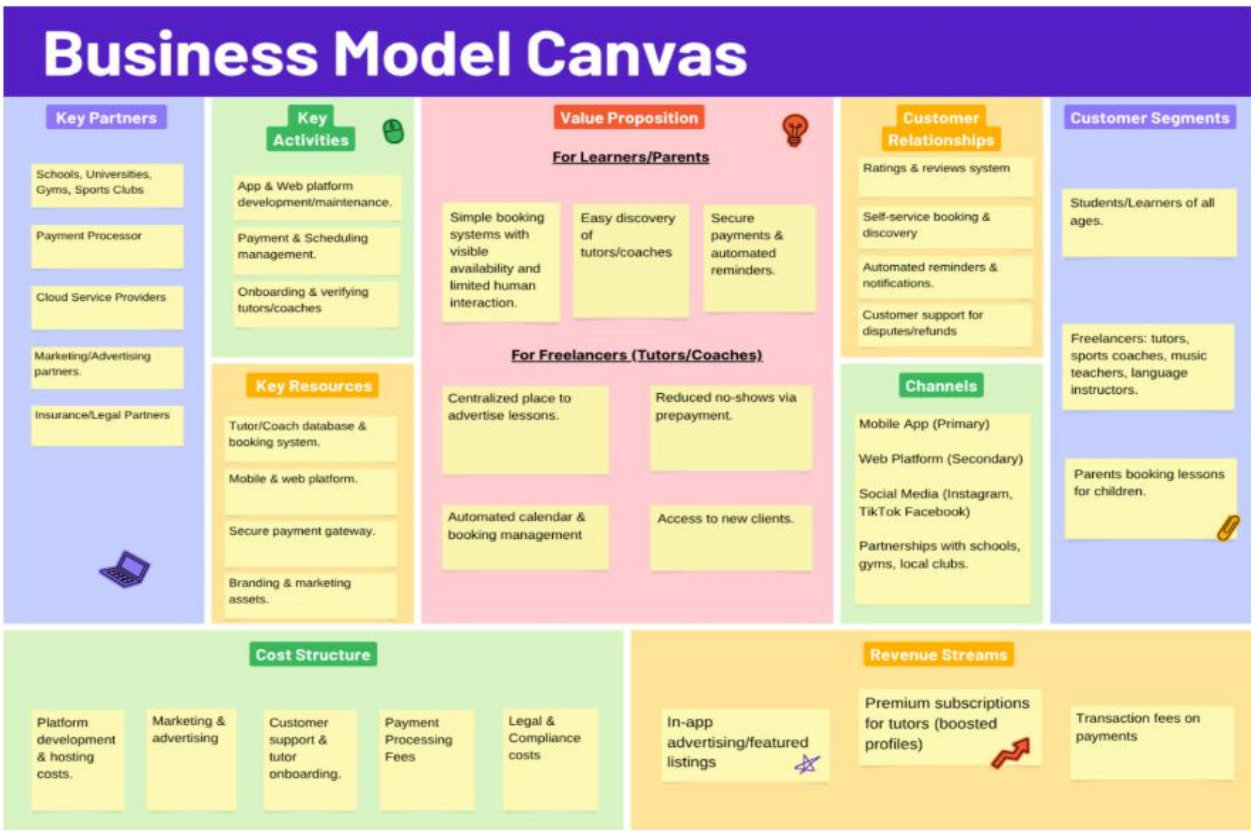

Figure 10: Business Model Canvas

The canvas identifies two distinct customer segments: learners and parents seeking tuition, and freelance instructors/tutors/coaches seeking students, with a tailored value proposition for each.

For learners, the platform offers simple, self-service booking with visible availability and automated payments. For tutors and coaches, it provides a centralised marketplace, automated scheduling, and reduced no-shows through prepayment.

Key activities centre on platform development, payment and scheduling management, and tutor onboarding. The primary revenue streams will come from tutor subscriptions, in-app featured listings, and transaction fees.

Cost drivers include platform hosting, marketing, payment processing, and legal compliance.

The canvas demonstrates that LevelUp! operates as a two-sided marketplace, where our platform's success depends on simultaneously attracting and retaining both tutors and learners, a core challenge reflected in the system design and functional requirements of our project.

3 Technical Delivery

3.1 Functional and Non-Functional Requirements

Functional requirements define the core operations that the LevelUp! platform must perform in order to support lesson booking and scheduling activities.

3.1.1 User Functional Requirements

User.FR1 — Users can register as a Student/Parent with username, email, password, name, and date of birth.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: Django User model with custom Role field, UserCreationForm validation.

User.FR2 — Users can search for coaches by category (Grinds/Sports/Music), subject/skill, mode (online/in-person), and area.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: Find lessons view with Django ORM filtering, query chaining on SessionSlot.

User.FR3 — Users can view a coach profile including bio, skills, hourly rate, verified status, and average star rating.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: CoachProfile model with M2M Skills, average_rating() computed method.

User.FR4 — Users can view coach availability on an interactive FullCalendar with colour-coded slots showing mode and area on the slot face.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: FullCalendar v6 CDN, JSON-serialised slots, CSS colour-coding by mode/category.

User.FR5 — Users can book an available session slot.
Criticality: Critical.
Implementation: Booking.create_booking() static method, transaction.atomic() for atomicity.

User.FR6 — Users can book a session on behalf of a child profile.
Criticality: Medium.
Implementation: ChildProfile model with ForeignKey to parent User, optional in booking form.

User.FR7 — Users can cancel a booking up to 24 hours before the session starts.
Criticality: Medium.
Implementation: can_cancel() method with datetime validation, 24hr threshold enforcement.

User.FR8 — Users can leave a 1–5 star review with optional comment after a confirmed session has ended.
Criticality: Low.
Implementation: Review model with ForeignKey to Booking, post-session validation.

User.FR9 — Users can create, view, and delete child profiles.
Criticality: Medium.
Implementation: ChildProfile CRUD views restricted to parent User.

3.1.2 Coach Functional Requirements

Coach.FR1 — Coaches can register with a subscription.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: CoachSubscription model, tier selection form during signup flow.

Coach.FR2 — Coaches can set individual session slots manually specifying skill, mode, area, and time.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: SessionSlot model, manual slot creation form with full_clean() validation.

Coach.FR3 — Coaches can set recurring availability by day of week, start time, and duration for up to 8 weeks ahead.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: Recurring slot generation loop in dashboard view, timezone.make_aware().

Coach.FR4 — Coaches can accept or reject in-person booking requests from students.
Criticality: Critical.
Implementation: Booking status update views (PENDING → CONFIRMED/REJECTED).

Coach.FR5 — Coaches can add a meeting link to confirmed online bookings.
Criticality: Low.
Implementation: Booking model meeting_link field, update form in coach dashboard.

Coach.FR6 — Coaches can cancel available slots or confirmed bookings from their dashboard.
Criticality: Medium.
Implementation: Slot/booking cancellation views, status updates to CANCELLED.

Coach.FR7 — Coaches can view their full schedule on a calendar showing both available (coloured) and booked (grey) slots.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: Coach dashboard FullCalendar with dual-status rendering.

3.1.3 System Requirements

Sys.FR1 — The system prevents double booking using atomic database transactions with select_for_update().
Criticality: Critical.
Implementation: transaction.atomic() with select_for_update() row-level locking.

Sys.FR2 — The system auto-generates session slots from recurring availability patterns using Europe/Dublin timezone.
Criticality: High.
Implementation: Recurring generation algorithm, timezone.make_aware() with Dublin timezone.

Sys.FR3 — Admin can mark coaches as verified through the Django admin panel.
Criticality: Low.
Implementation: CoachProfile is_verified BooleanField, Django admin interface.

3.1.4 Non-Functional Requirements

Sys.NFR1 - Security - Django session-based authentication; passwords hashed with CSRF protection on all forms.
Implementation: Django built-in auth, CsrfViewMiddleware.

Sys.NFR2 - Performance - Atomic booking using select_for_update() prevents race conditions under concurrent requests.
Implementation: transaction.atomic() with row-level locking.

Sys.NFR3 - GDPR - Child profiles store only name, DOB, and year group; parent retains full control; no separate login for children.
Implementation: ChildProfile model, GDPR Article 8 compliant.

Sys.NFR4 - Timezone - All session slots stored and displayed in Europe/Dublin timezone (UTC+1 IST in summer).
Implementation: timezone.make_aware() with TIME_ZONE=Europe/Dublin.

Sys.NFR5 - Usability - Search shows prompt until filters applied; calendar shows mode/area on slot face without clicking.
Implementation: find_lessons.html searched flag; FullCalendar event titles.

3.2 User Stories

User stories were used to identify how different users interact with the LevelUp! platform and to guide the development of system functionality. These stories represent typical actions performed by users when using the system.

3.2.1 Student / Adult Learner User Stories

- I want to search for instructors by subject or activity.
- I want to view available session times on a calendar so that I can select a convenient time to attend a lesson.
- I want to book a lesson online so that my session is confirmed immediately without needing to contact the instructor directly.
- I want to cancel or update bookings when necessary.
- I want to leave a review after completing a lesson so that I can provide feedback on the instructor’s service.

3.2.2 Parent User Stories

- I want to create and manage a child profile so that I can book lessons on behalf of my child.
- I want to view available lesson times and book sessions for my child.
- I want to receive confirmation of bookings so that I know the lesson has been successfully scheduled.
- I want to cancel or update bookings when necessary.

3.2.3 Instructor / Coach / Teacher User Stories

- I want to create available session slots so that students can book lessons at times that suit my schedule.
- I want to set recurring availability so that regular lesson times can be created automatically.
- I want to view and manage my upcoming bookings so that I can prepare for scheduled lessons.
- I want to cancel or update session availability so that my schedule remains accurate.
- I want to view feedback and ratings from students so that I can monitor the quality of my service.

3.2.4 Administrator User Stories

- I want to manage user accounts so that the platform operates securely and users can be supported when issues occur.
- I want to monitor platform activity so that system performance and usage can be reviewed.
- I want to maintain system integrity so that bookings and user data remain accurate and secure

3.3 UML Use Case for the Prototype

The UML Use Case Diagram illustrates how different users interact with the LevelUp! platform and access its core functionality. The system supports a range of lesson types across education, sport, and music services, and the diagram demonstrates the key actions performed by each user role within the system.

Students, parents, and adult learners can create accounts, search for instructors or coaches, view available session times, and complete bookings through the platform. They can also manage profiles, leave reviews after completing lessons, and view their upcoming or past sessions.
Instructors, coaches, and teachers can create accounts, manage their availability schedules, define the services they offer, and monitor incoming bookings. They can update session times, manage lesson information, and maintain their profiles to ensure that accurate information is presented to users.

Administrators have additional privileges that allow them to manage user accounts, oversee platform activity, and maintain system functionality. These administrative capabilities help ensure the platform operates securely and efficiently.

The figure below provides a visual representation of this the UML cases used in LevelUp!

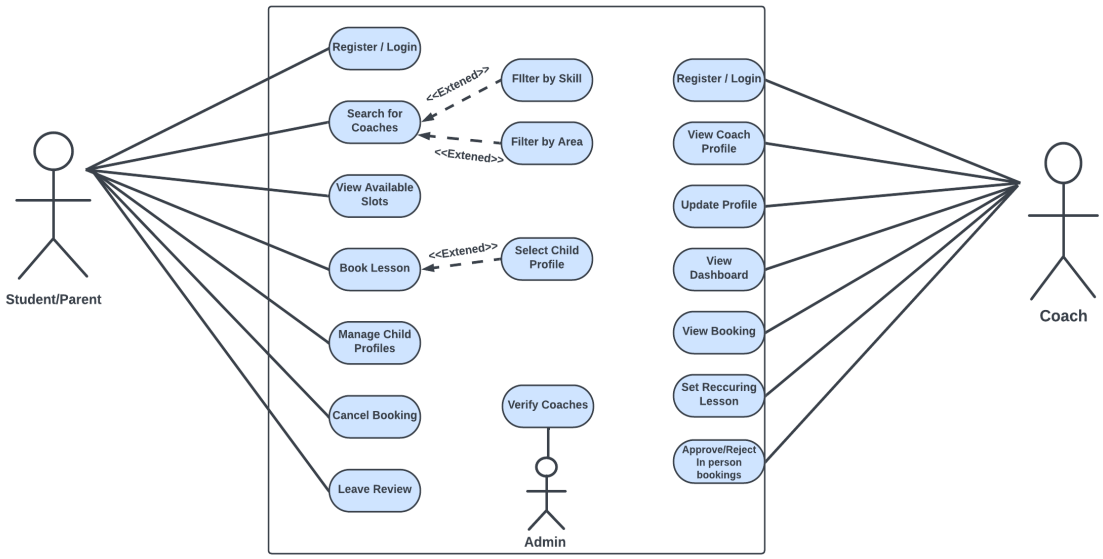

Figure 11: UML Use Case

3.4 Business Process Modelling Notation (BPMN)

3.4.1 Lesson Booking Process BPMN

The diagram shown in Figure 12 visualises the process followed when a user books a lesson through the platform.

The workflow includes selecting an instructor/tutor/coach, choosing an available session slot, confirming the booking, and storing the booking record in the system.

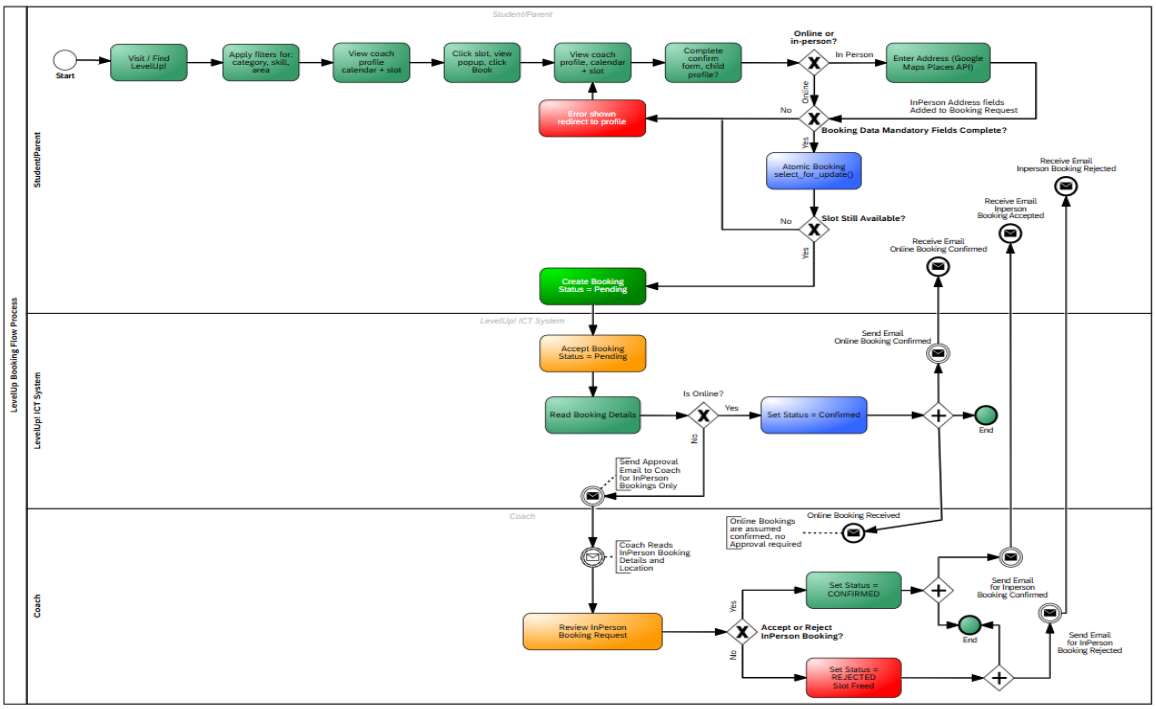

Figure 12: Student/Learner booking a lesson

3.4.2 Session Availability Management

The diagram shown in Figure 13 illustrates how instructors/tutors create and manage available session slots. The workflow includes defining session details, generating availability, and updating the system schedule.

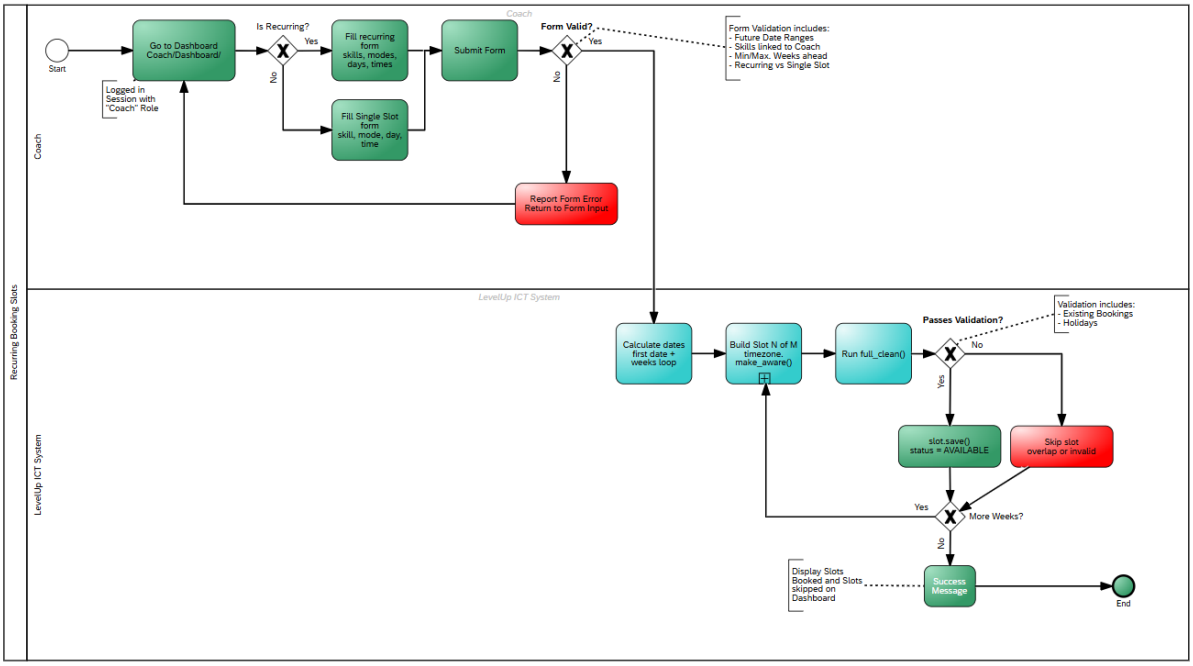

Figure 13: Instructor/Teacher/Coach setting available slots

3.5 Software Architecture of the Proposed Solution

The LevelUp! platform uses a layered web application architecture consisting of three primary components: the client interface, the application server, and the database. This architecture separates user interaction from application logic and data storage, improving system organisation and maintainability.

The client layer represents the user interface of the system and is responsible for displaying pages such as instructor listings, booking calendars, and user dashboards. This interface was developed using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Bootstrap to provide a responsive and user-friendly experience across devices.

The application server layer is responsible for processing user requests and executing system functionality. This layer was implemented using Python and the Django framework. It manages tasks such as user authentication, availability validation, booking creation, and review management. The server also ensures that booking conflicts are prevented by validating lesson availability before confirming reservations.

The database layer stores all system information, including user accounts, instructor profiles, lesson schedules, bookings, and reviews. This data is accessed through Django's Object-Relational Mapping (ORM) system, which allows developers to interact with database records using Python code.

Currently, the LevelUp! platform utilises the built-in SQLite database provided by the Django framework. This database solution is suitable for development because it requires minimal

configuration and provides reliable performance for a prototype system. However, when the platform is deployed and the number of users increases, the system may require a more scalable database solution to support higher levels of activity and data storage. The system can be migrated to a more scalable database solution such as PostgreSQL or a cloud-based database service. This transition would improve system reliability and allow the platform to support a larger number of users as demand increases.

The figure below provides a visual representation of the components used in LevelUp!

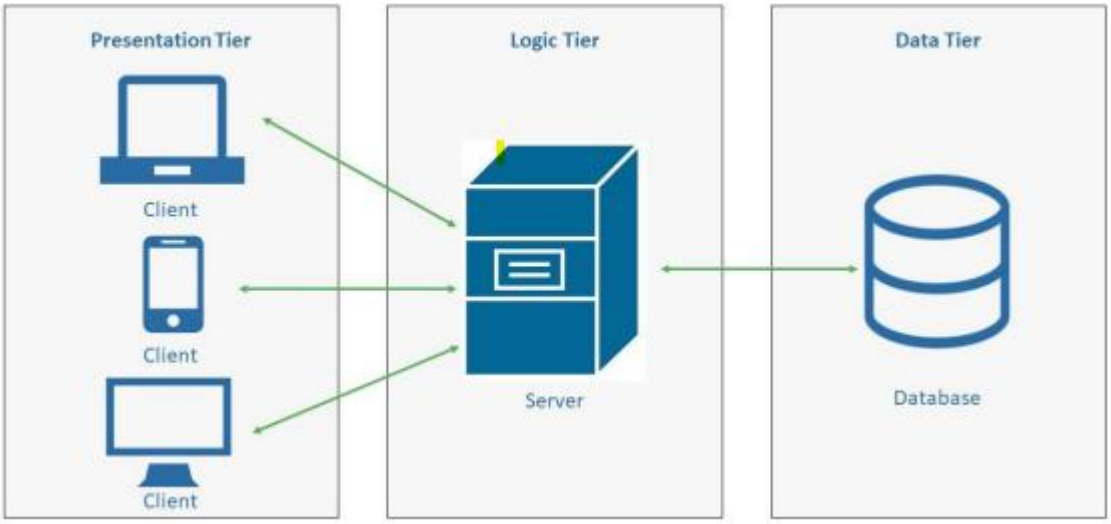

Figure 14: 3 Tier Architecture

3.6 Logical Database Design and Data Storage Requirements

The LevelUp! platform relies on a relational database to manage system data and maintain accurate booking records. The database structure was designed to ensure that information can be stored securely and retrieved efficiently while supporting relationships between users, instructors, and bookings.

The system currently uses SQLite as the default database provided by Django. This database is sufficient for development because it requires minimal configuration and provides reliable performance for small to medium user volumes. However, when the platform is deployed, the system can be migrated to a more scalable database solution such as PostgreSQL or a cloud-based database service. This transition would allow the platform to support increased user activity and maintain consistent performance as demand grows.

The database includes several key entities, including users, instructor profiles, subjects, session slots, bookings, and reviews. Each entity contains a unique identifier that allows records to be linked together through defined relationships. For example, a booking record is associated with both a student and an instructor, ensuring that lesson schedules are consistent.

Primary keys are used to uniquely identify records, while foreign keys maintain relationships between tables. This structure ensures data consistency and supports efficient retrieval of booking

and scheduling information. The figure below provides a visual Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) for the LevelUp! system.

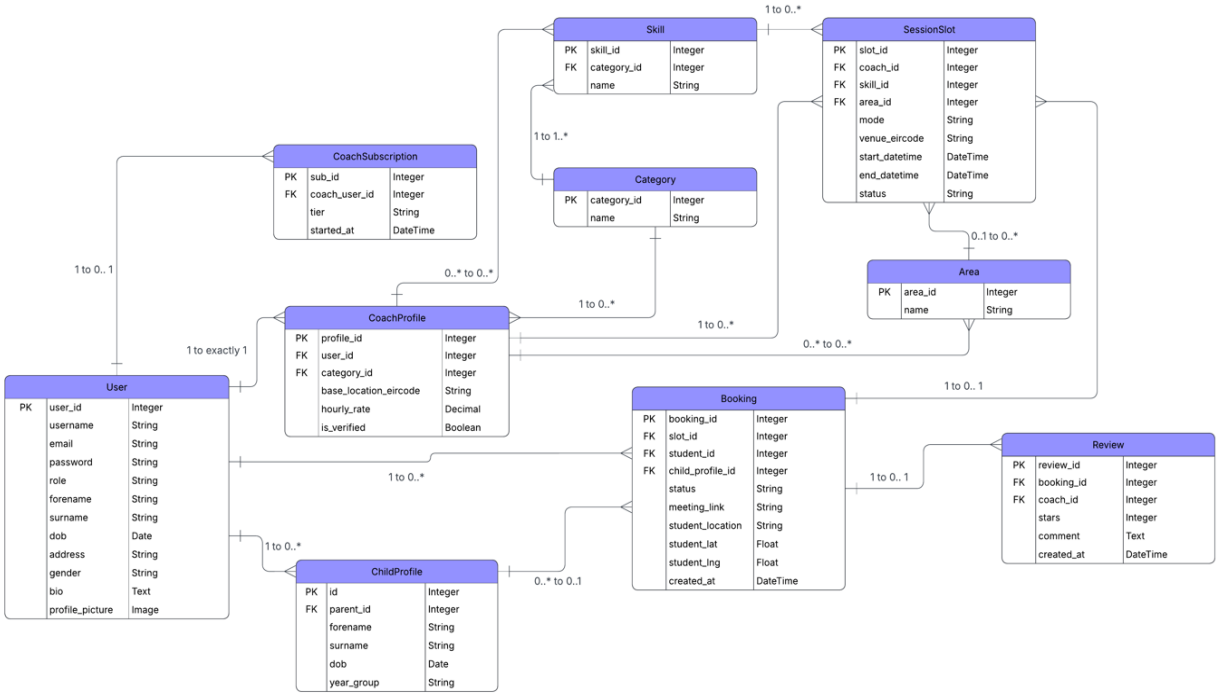

Figure 15: LevelUp! ERD

3.6.1 Types of Data Stored in the System

The following is a list of data processed by the system.

User and Account Data

The system stores information required to manage user accounts and allow secure access to the platform. This data supports authentication, account management, and user identification within the system.

Instructor Profile Data

The platform stores information related to lesson providers and the services they offer. This data allows users to view available services and supports the discovery and booking of lessons through the system.

Scheduling and Availability Data

Scheduling data is stored to manage lesson availability and ensure that bookings can be organised effectively. This information allows the system to display available time slots and maintain an accurate record of scheduled sessions.

Booking and Activity Data

Booking data records details of confirmed reservations and system activity related to lesson scheduling. This data helps ensure that bookings are processed correctly and allows users to review their upcoming or past sessions.

Data Security and Reliability

Ensuring the security and reliability of stored data is essential to maintaining user trust and system stability. The platform uses built-in authentication and permission controls provided by the Django framework to restrict access to authorised users only.

Access controls and encryption mechanisms help protect sensitive information, while secure login procedures reduce the risk of unauthorised access. These measures support compliance with data protection regulations and ensure that user information is handled responsibly.

Regular database backups are implemented to prevent data loss in the event of technical failure or system errors. These backups allow the system to recover important information quickly if unexpected issues occur.

3.7 External Software Interfaces

The LevelUp! platform integrates two external software components to support scheduling and location functionality.

3.7.1 Calendars

The first external component used in the system is the FullCalendar JavaScript library [11]. This library provides an interactive calendar interface that allows instructors to create and manage available lesson times. It also enables students and parents to view available session slots and select suitable booking times. The use of FullCalendar significantly improved the usability of the scheduling system and reduced development complexity.

```javascript
document.addEventListener('DOMContentLoaded', function () {
    const cal = new FullCalendar.Calendar(document.getElementById('dashboard-calendar'), {
        initialView: 'timeGridWeek',
        initialDate: DASHBOARD_EVENTS.length ? new Date(DASHBOARD_EVENTS[0].start) : new Date(),
        headerToolbar: { left: 'prev,next today', center: 'title', right: 'dayGridMonth,timeGridWeek,timeGridDay' },
        buttonText: { today: 'Today', month: 'Month', week: 'Week', day: 'Day' },
        events: DASHBOARD_EVENTS,
        allDaySlot: false,
        slotMinTime: '10:00:00',
        slotMaxTime: '20:00:00',
        nowIndicator: true,
        height: 'auto',
        // No click handler — coach view is read-only on the calendar
        eventDidMount(info) {
            const p = info.event.extendedProps;
            info.el.title = `${p.skill} · ${p.mode}${p.area ? ' · ' + p.area : ''} · ${p.status}`;
            if (info.event.start < new Date() && p.status === 'AVAILABLE') {
                info.el.style.opacity = '0.45';
            }
        },
    });
    cal.render();
});
```

Figure 16: FullCalendar Javascript

3.7.2 Maps and Locations

The second external component used in the platform is the Google Maps Places API [12]. This service allows users to identify where sessions will take place. The integration of mapping functionality improves user confidence and supports in-person lesson scheduling.

```
function initMap() {
    const input = document.getElementById(
        '{{ form.student_location.id_for_label }}'
    );

    const latField = document.getElementById(
        '{{ form.student_lat.id_for_label }}'
    );

    const lngField = document.getElementById(
        '{{ form.student_lng.id_for_label }}'
    );

    const mapDiv = document.getElementById('map-preview');
    const mapLabel = document.getElementById('map-label');

    // Restrict suggestions to Ireland
    const options = {
        componentRestrictions: { country: "ie" },
        fields: ["formatted_address", "geometry"],
    };

    const autocomplete =
        new google.maps.places.Autocomplete(input, options);

    let map = null;
    let marker = null;

    autocomplete.addListener("place_changed", function () {
        const place = autocomplete.getPlace();

        if (!place.geometry) return;

        const lat = place.geometry.location.lat();
        const lng = place.geometry.location.lng();

        // Store coords in hidden fields so Django saves them
        latField.value = lat;
        lngField.value = lng;

        // Show the map
        mapDiv.style.display = "block";
        mapLabel.style.display = "block";

        if (!map) {
            map = new google.maps.Map(mapDiv, {
                zoom: 15,
                center: { lat, lng },
                mapTypeControl: false,
                streetViewControl: false,
                fullscreenControl: false,
            });

            marker = new google.maps.Marker({
                position: { lat, lng },
                map: map,
                title: place.formatted_address,
            });

        } else {
            // Update existing map and marker
            map.setCenter({ lat, lng });
            marker.setPosition({ lat, lng });
        }
    });
}
```

Figure 17: Google Maps Places API

3.8 Performance Requirements

The performance requirements focus on maintaining stable operation, reliable booking functionality, and continuous availability for users.

3.8.1 Response Time

User Interface (UI) Responsiveness:
The application should load within approximately 2–3 seconds under normal operating conditions.

Booking Actions:
Booking creation, session management, and cancellation actions should complete and return a response to the user within 3 seconds under normal operating conditions. This requirement will be

reviewed and tightened as part of any transition to a production-grade database and hosting environment.

3.8.2 Scalability

User Scalability:
The system should support multiple users accessing and using the platform at the same time without performance issues.

Data Scalability:
The system should handle increasing volumes of users, bookings, and scheduling data as the platform grows.

3.8.3 Availability

Service Availability:
The website should be available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. In the current prototype deployment, availability is subject to the constraints of the development environment. A production deployment would target a minimum of 99.5% uptime, requiring appropriate redundancy and monitoring in place.

System Continuity:
The system should recover quickly from temporary technical issues and resume normal operation.

3.8.4 Reliability

Data Integrity:
The platform should prevent double bookings through validation checks and atomic booking transactions.

User Feedback:
The system should display clear and user-friendly error messages when problems occur.

3.9 Working Prototype Software

The LevelUp! platform has been developed as a working prototype that demonstrates the core functionality of the system. The prototype allows users to register accounts, search for instructors and coaches, manage availability, and complete bookings through an interactive scheduling interface.

Instructors and coaches can manage their schedules by creating available session slots and updating lesson details through their dashboard. They can also view upcoming bookings and monitor session activity. The prototype demonstrates the feasibility of the platform and provides a foundation for future development and expansion.

3.9.1 Home Page

The home page provides the main entry point to the LevelUp! platform. It introduces users to the service and provides navigation links to key features such as searching for instructors, creating an account, and logging into the system.

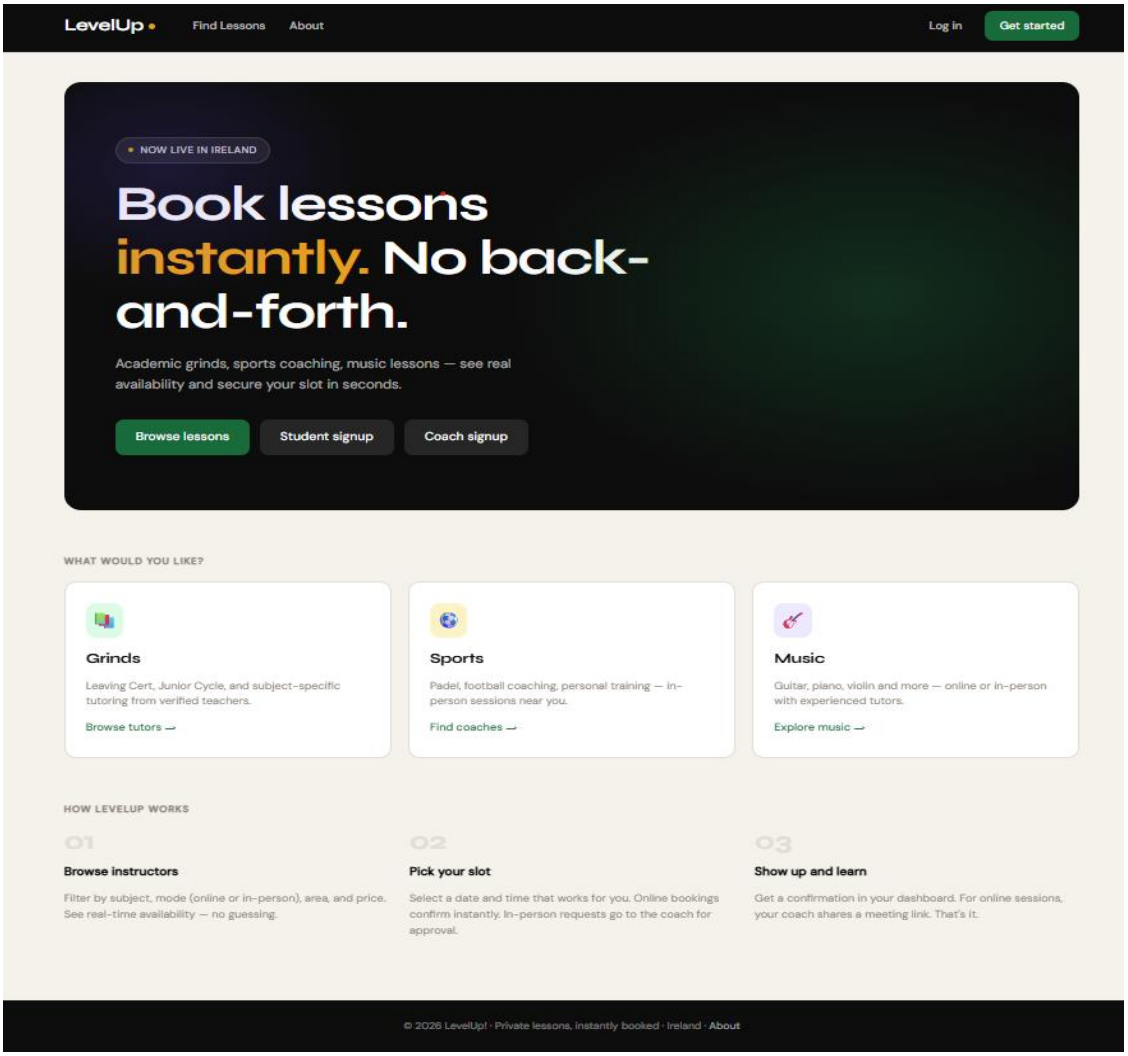

Figure 18: Home Page

3.9.2 Create Account Page

This page allows new users to select the type of account they want to create.

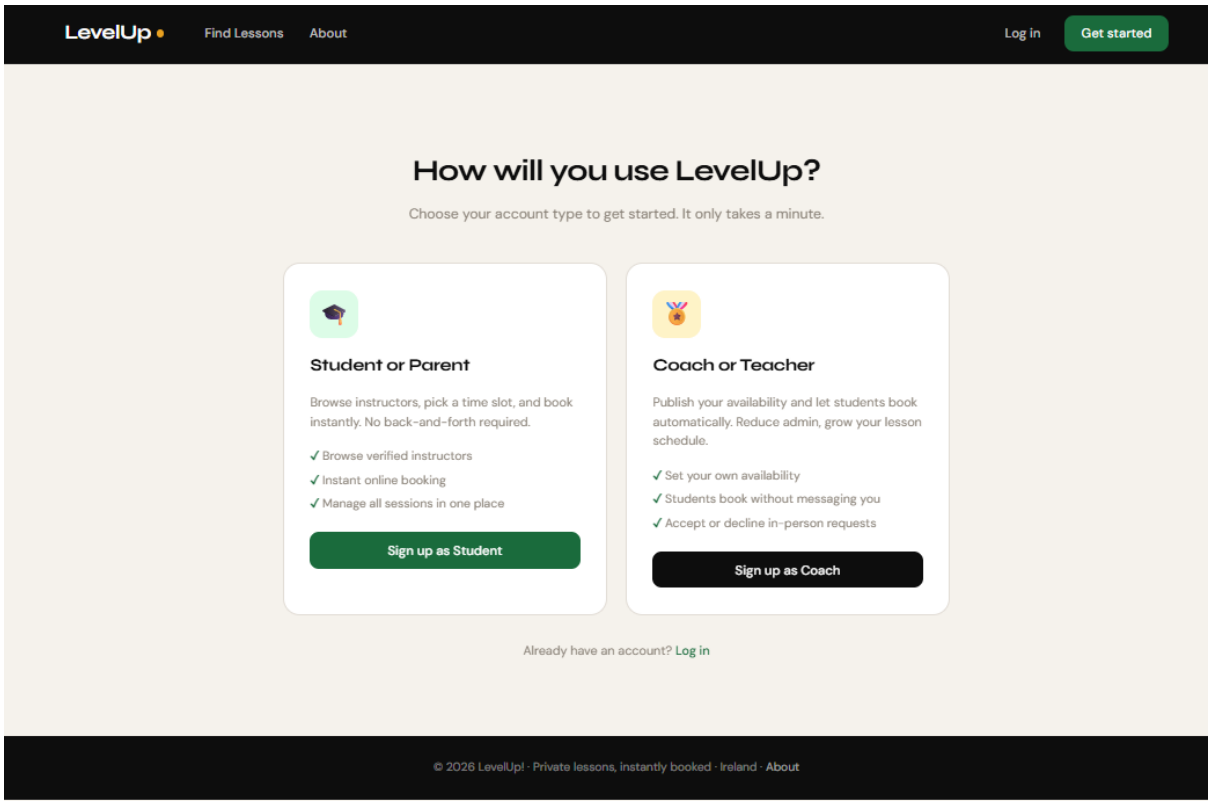

Figure 19: Create Account Page

3.9.3 User Registration Page

This page allows new users to create an account by entering their personal details. The system validates the input information and securely stores user credentials within the database.

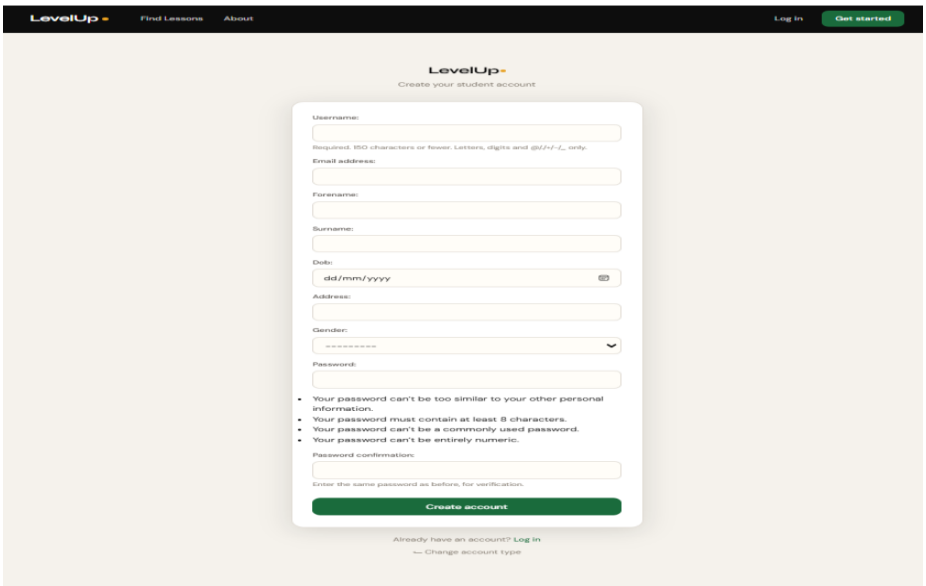

Figure 20: User Registration Page

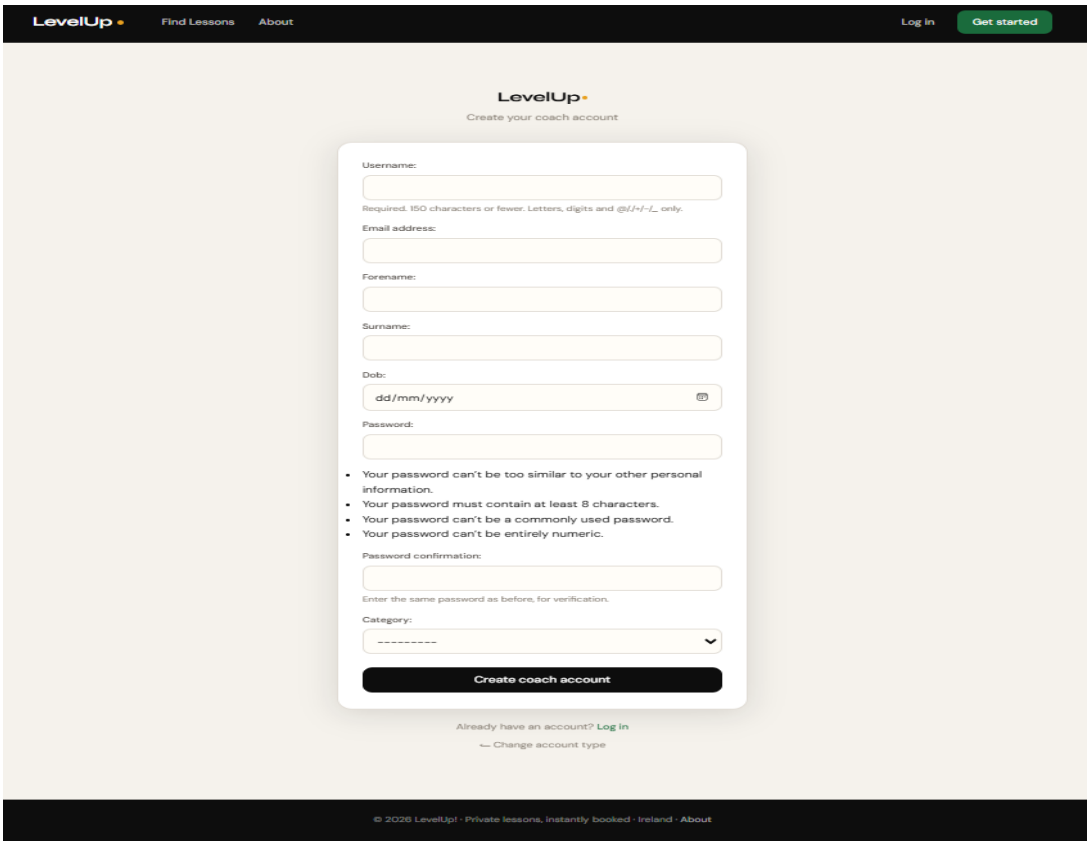

Figure 21: Instructor/Coach Registration Page

3.9.4 Login Page

The login page allows registered users to securely access their accounts using their email and password. Authentication is handled by the Django framework to ensure secure login functionality.

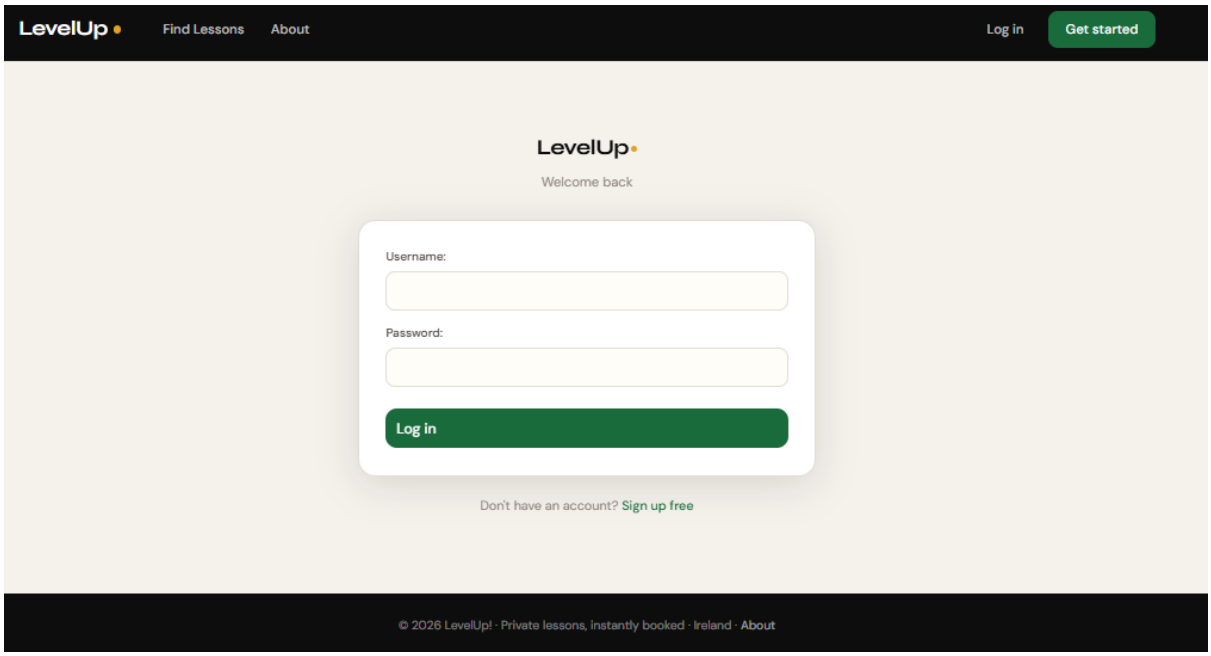

Figure 22: Login Page

3.9.5 Profile Page

The profile page shows the users personal details and allows editing.

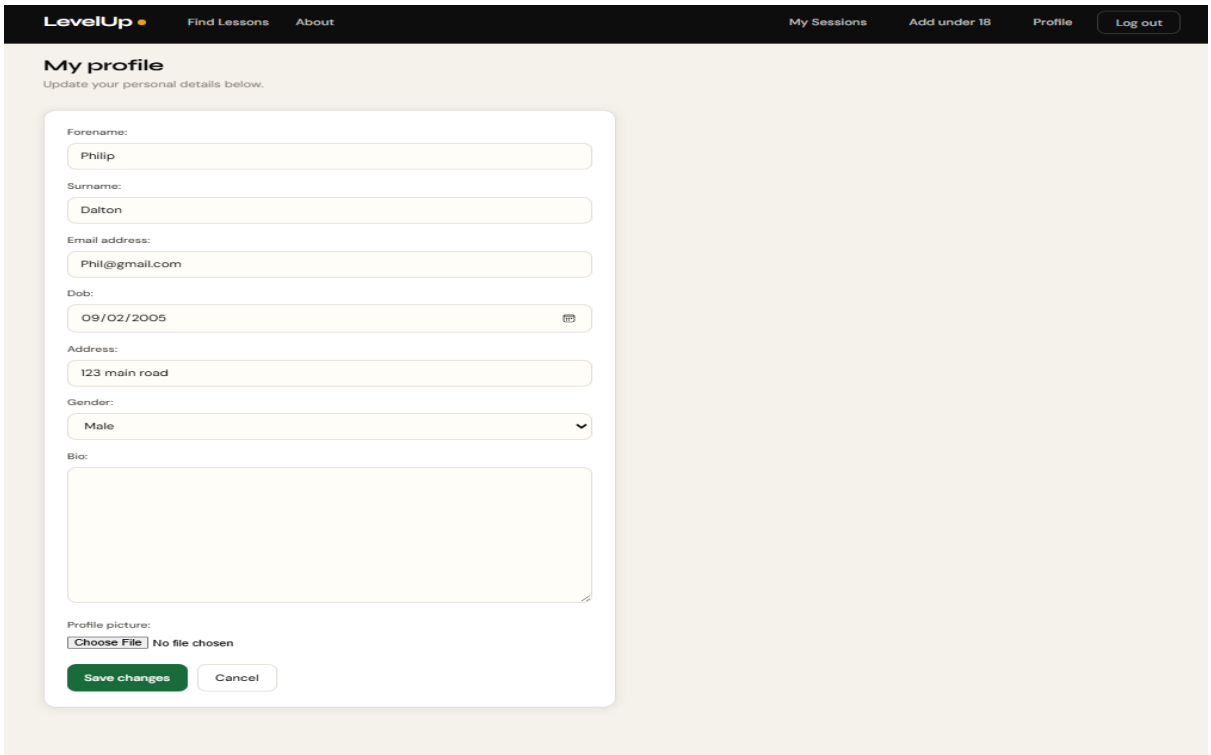

Figure 23: Profile Page

3.9.6 Instructor and Coach Search Page

This page allows users to search for instructors or coaches across multiple categories, including grinds, sports, and music. Users can filter results by subject or skill, lesson mode, and location to find suitable services.

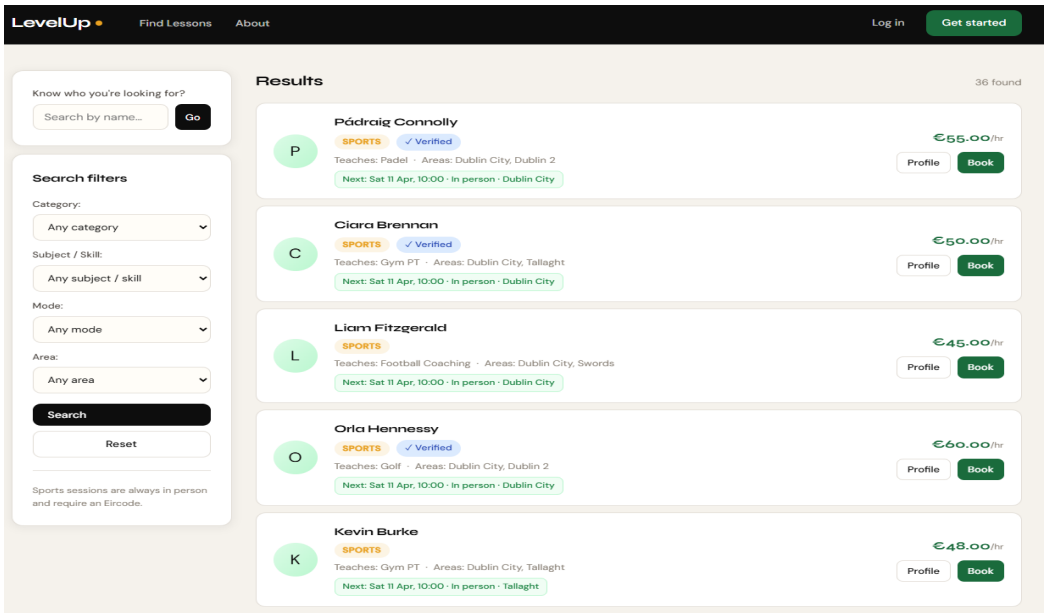

Figure 24: Instructor and Coach Search Page

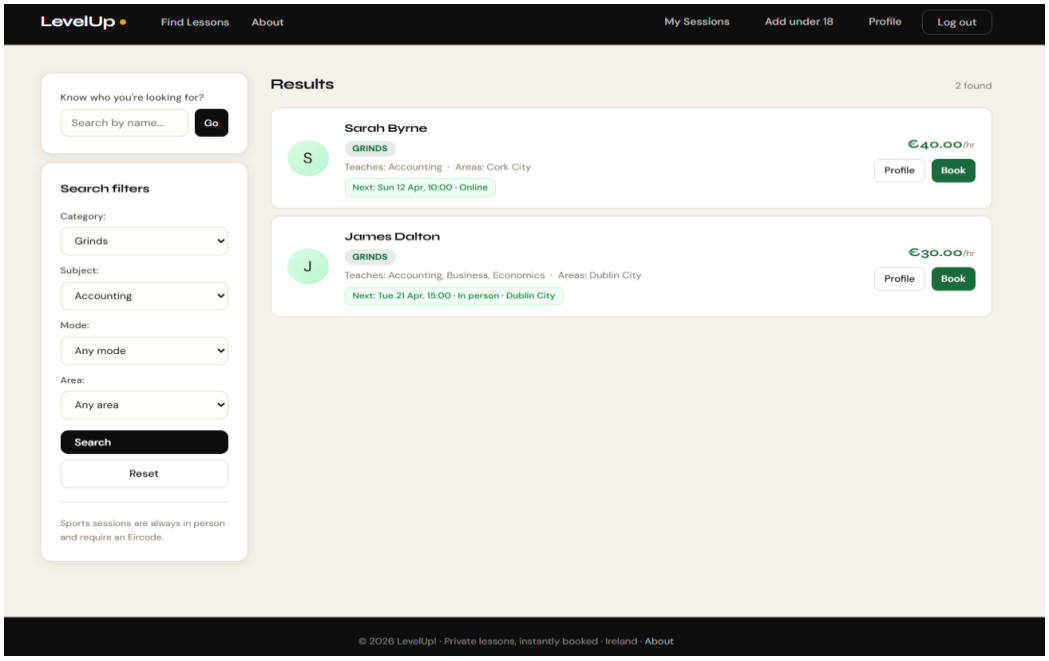

Figure 25: Search Using Filters

3.9.7 Coach Profile and Availability Page

This page displays detailed information about an instructor or coach, including their biography, skills, hourly rate, verification status, and average review rating. Users can review the available information before selecting a session.

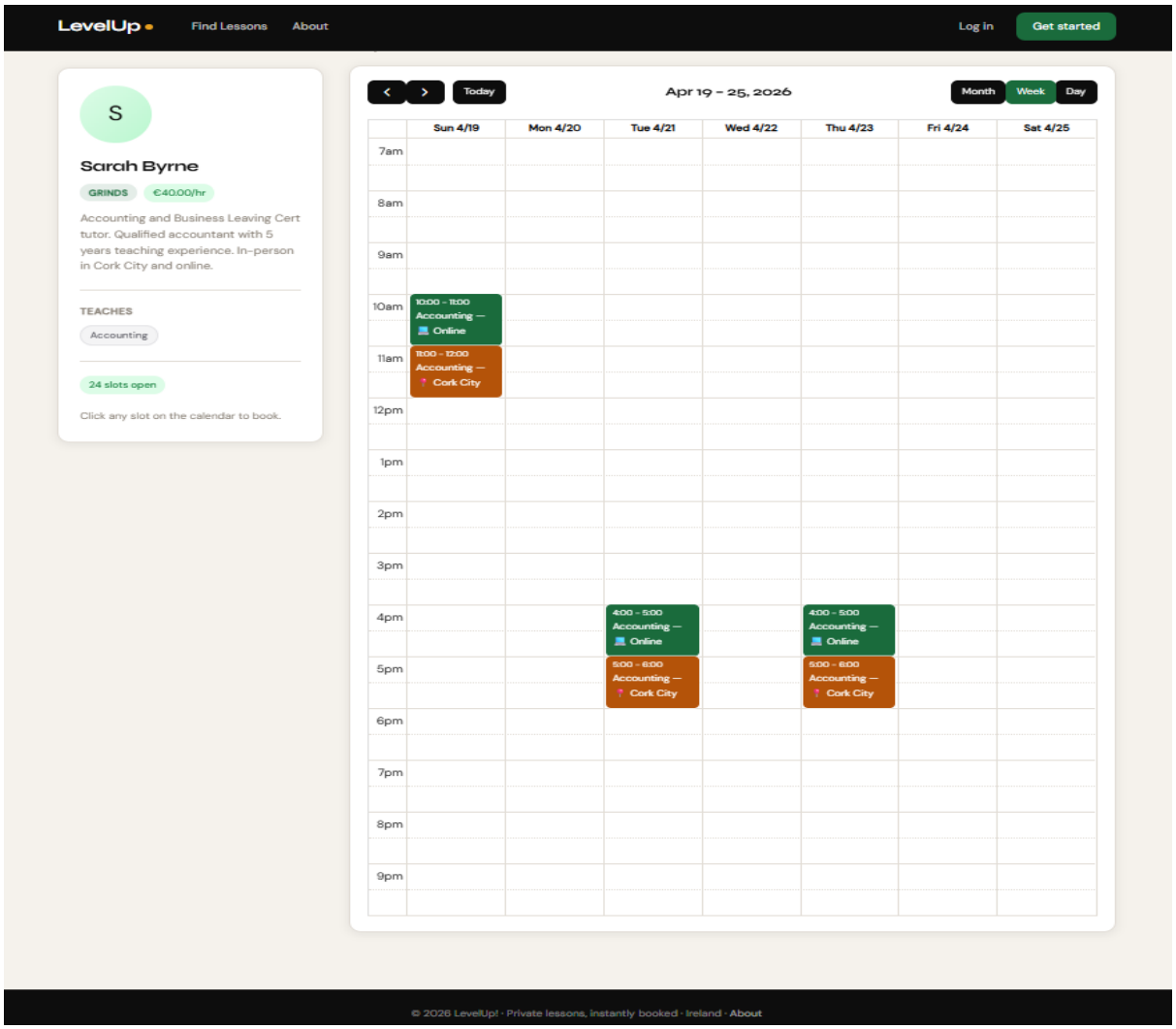

Figure 26: Coach Profile and Availability Page

3.9.8 Booking Confirmation Page

This page confirms that a booking has been successfully created and displays the details of the scheduled session. The system updates the instructor's availability and stores the booking record in the database.

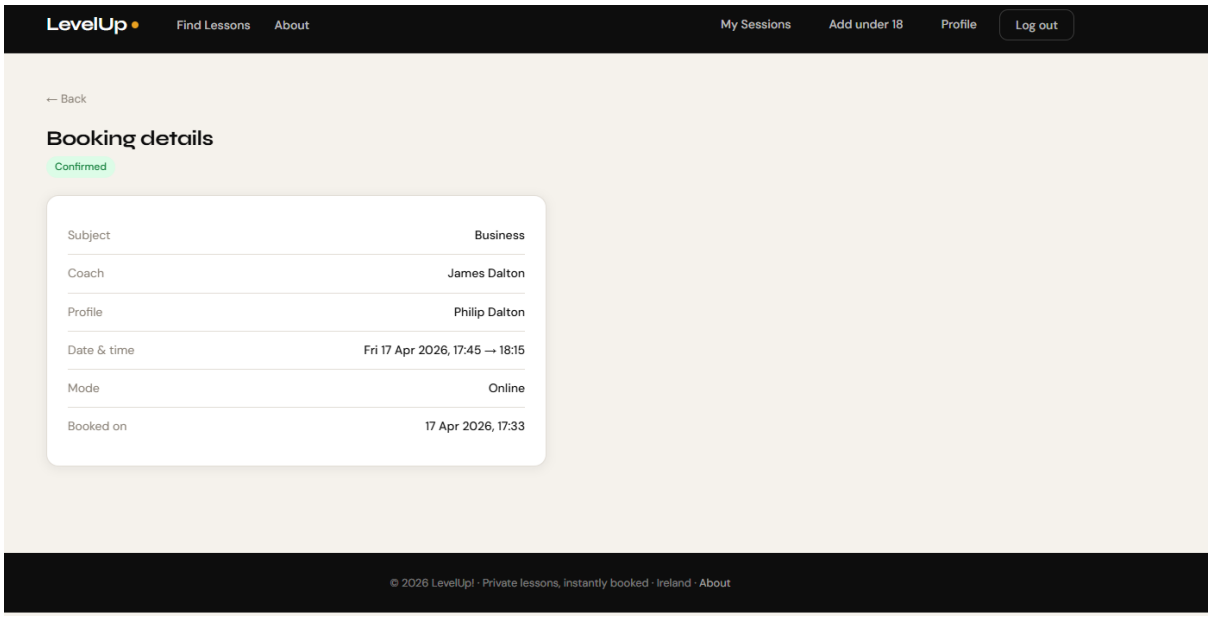

Figure 27: Booking Confirmation Page

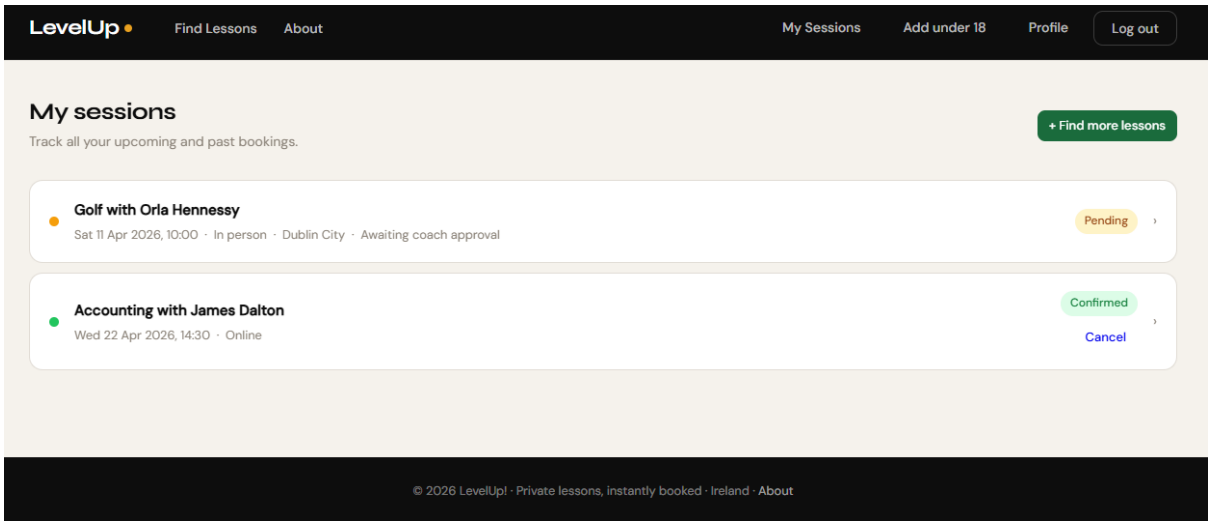

Figure 28: My sessions

3.9.9 Coach Dashboard Page

This page allows instructors and coaches to manage their availability and monitor upcoming bookings. Users can create session slots, generate recurring availability, and update lesson details directly from the dashboard.

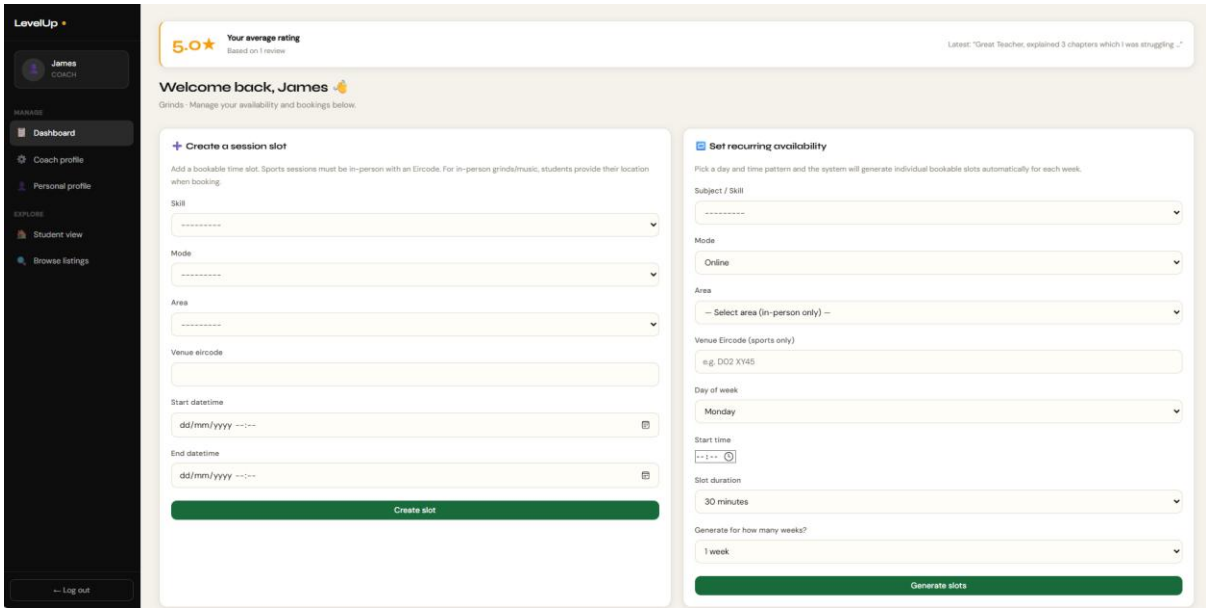

Figure 29: Coach Dashboard

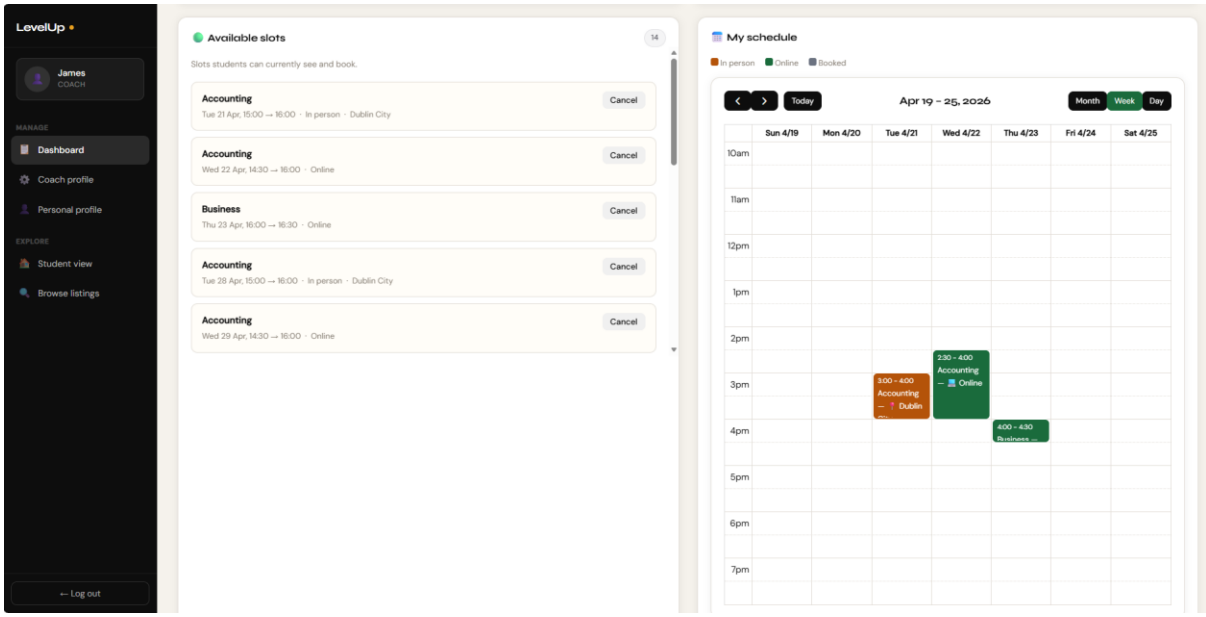

Figure 30: Coach Dashboard Continued

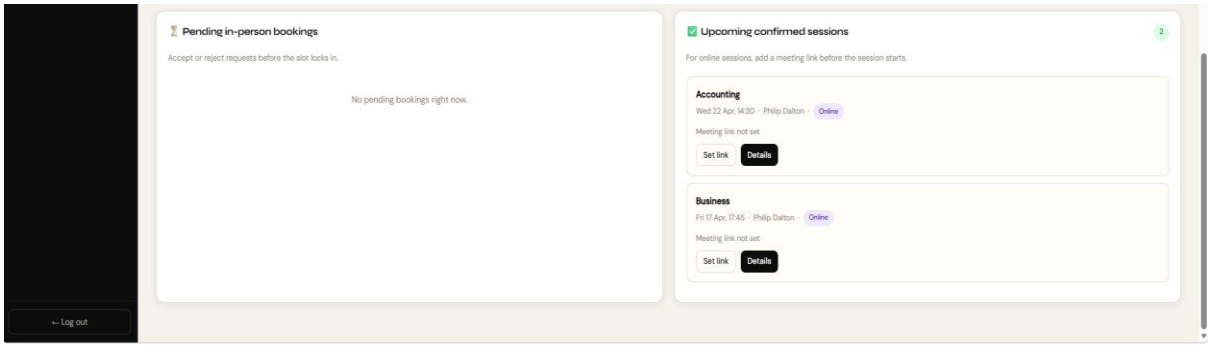

Figure 31: Coach Dashboard Continued

3.9.10 Review Submission Page

This page allows users to leave a rating and optional comment after completing a lesson. Reviews are linked to completed bookings and contribute to the instructor's overall rating.

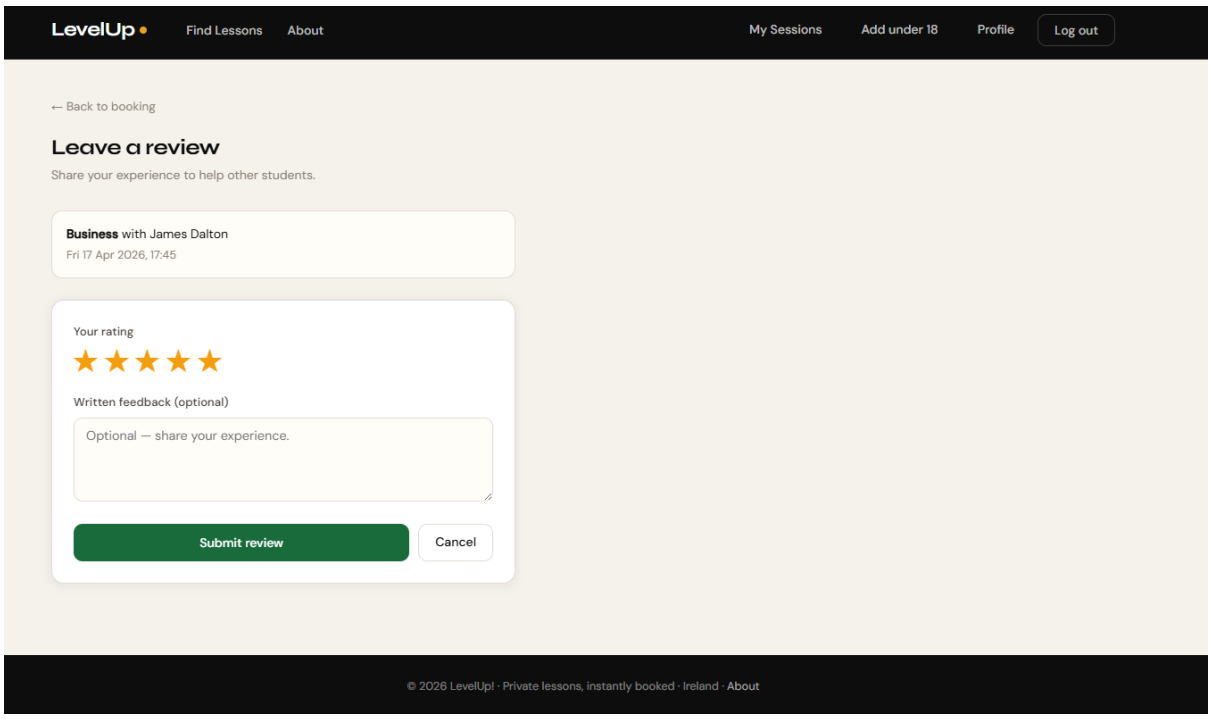

Figure 32: Review Submission Page

3.9.11 Add Under 18 to Account Page

This page allows users to add an under 18 child profile to their account. They can then book sessions on behalf of that child.

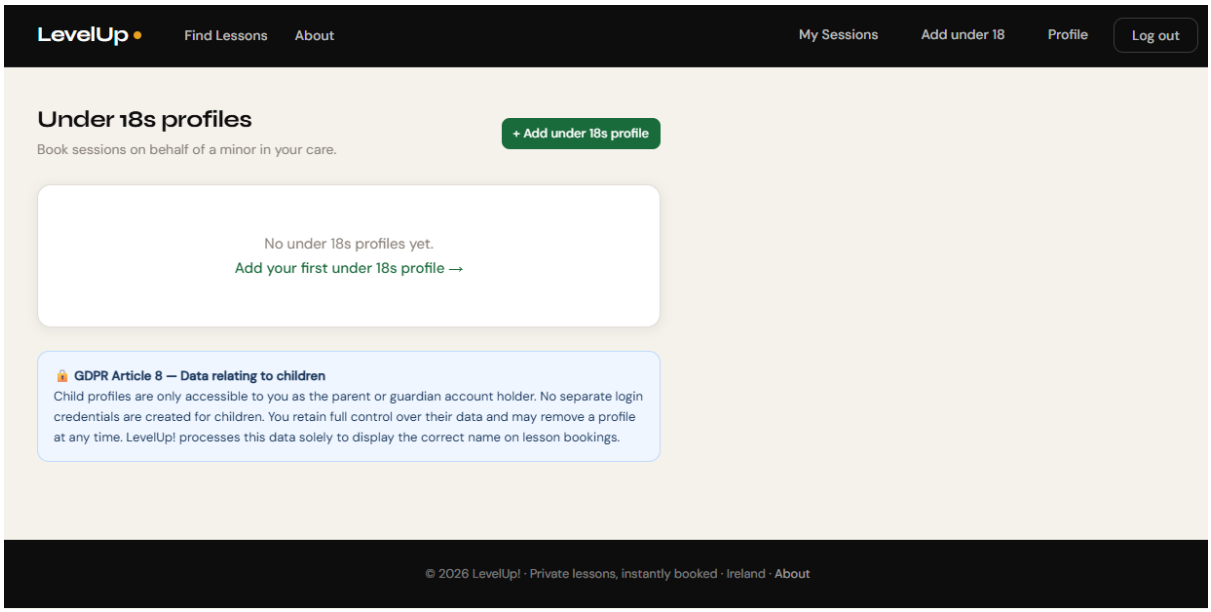

Figure 33: Add Under 18 to Account Page

3.9.12 About Page

The About page displays the platform's core value proposition for both students and instructors.

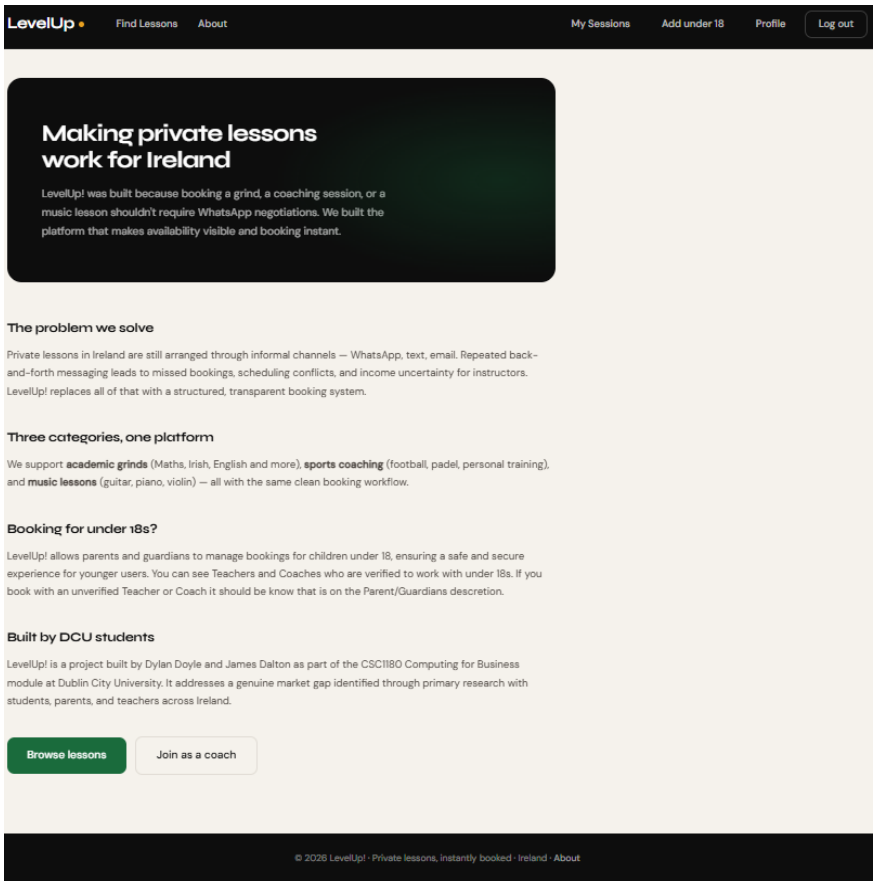

Figure 34: About Page

3.10 Technical Challenges to be Solved in Bringing this Project to Market

Although the LevelUp! platform has been successfully developed as a working prototype, several significant technical challenges remain to be addressed before the system can be deployed as a fully operational commercial service.

3.10.1 Database Migration and Scalability

The current implementation uses SQLite as the default database provided by the Django framework. While suitable for development and testing, SQLite is not designed to support the levels of concurrent activity expected in a production environment, particularly during peak demand periods. Migrating to a production-grade database such as PostgreSQL would address these limitations by providing row-level locking, improved indexing, query optimisation, and robust backup capabilities.

3.10.2 Payment Processing Integration

The LevelUp! business model depends on a booking fee per completed session and a monthly instructor subscription, neither of which is currently implemented in the prototype. Adding a payment system like Stripe would involve securely handling card information, managing subscription payments, processing refunds when sessions are cancelled, and responding to payment notifications sent by the system.

3.10.3 Mobile Responsiveness and Native Application Strategy

While the current prototype adapts to different screen sizes, dedicated mobile optimisation is required before launch given that a significant proportion of bookings are likely to be initiated on mobile devices. Specific challenges include optimising the FullCalendar interface for touch-based interaction, improving the usability of the booking flow and search filters on smaller screens. A key strategic decision is whether to invest in native iOS and Android applications or to implement the platform as a Progressive Web Application (PWA).

3.10.4 Automated Notifications and Communication

The current system records bookings within the platform but does not yet deliver automated email or SMS notifications. A production deployment requires transactional messaging for booking confirmations, cancellation notices, session reminders, and instructor approval requests for in-person bookings. This requires integration with a provider such as Mailgun [13], along with deliverability monitoring and unsubscribe handling.

3.10.5 Data Protection and Regulatory Compliance

A commercial deployment requires a data protection programme. This includes completing a Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) [14], implementing Subject Access Request workflows, defining data retention policies for booking records and personal data, and maintaining a documented breach notification procedure aligned with the 72-hour GDPR notification requirement. Given that

the platform processes personal data relating to minors and facilitates financial transactions, these obligations are material and must be addressed prior to any public launch.

3.10.6 Search Performances

The current instructor search relies on Django ORM filtering, which performs adequately at prototype scale but would start to decline as the number of instructors and session slots grows. A production deployment would benefit from a dedicated search solution such as PostgreSQL full-text search or Elasticsearch, supporting geographic proximity search and relevance ranking.

3.11 Source Code Highlights

The LevelUp! platform was developed using Python and the Django web framework to support secure user management, scheduling functionality, and booking operations. The following code snippets highlight important parts of the implementation that demonstrate how core system functionality was achieved.

3.11.1 Booking.create_booking() — Double Booking Prevention

One of the most important parts of the system is the create_booking() method, which is responsible for safely creating bookings while preventing two users from reserving the same session at the same time. The method ensures that once a user selects a time slot, the system temporarily locks that slot while the booking is being processed. If another user attempts to book the same slot during this time, the system checks the availability again and prevents the second booking from being completed.

This approach ensures that scheduling conflicts cannot occur and that booking information remains accurate. Online sessions are confirmed immediately after booking, while in-person sessions are initially marked as pending until the coach approves the request.

```python
@staticmethod
def create_booking(slot, student, child_profile=None):
    # Atomic booking prevents two students booking the same slot at the same time
    if student.role != User.Role.STUDENT:
        raise PermissionDenied("Only students can make bookings.")

    if child_profile and child_profile.parent_id != student.id:
        raise PermissionDenied("That child profile does not belong to your account.")

    with transaction.atomic():
        # Lock the slot row so no other request can book it at the same time
        locked = SessionSlot.objects.select_for_update().get(pk=slot.pk)

        if locked.status != SessionSlot.Status.AVAILABLE:
            raise ValidationError("This slot is no longer available.")

        # Online = confirmed instantly, In-person = pending coach approval
        status = (
            Booking.Status.PENDING
            if locked.mode == SessionSlot.Mode.IN_PERSON
            else Booking.Status.CONFIRMED
        )

        locked.status = SessionSlot.Status.BOOKED
        locked.save(update_fields=["status"])

        return Booking.objects.create(
            slot=locked,
            student=student,
            child_profile=child_profile,
            status=status,
        )
```

Figure 35: Double Booking Prevention

3.11.2 SessionSlot.clean() — Slot Validation Rules

The clean() method on the SessionSlot model ensures that all scheduling rules are checked before a new session slot can be saved.

The method verifies that the session times are valid, that the coach is authorised to teach the selected skill, and that required location information is provided for in-person sessions. It also checks that the new session does not overlap with any existing sessions for the same coach.

```
def clean(self):
    # Start must be before end
    if self.start_datetime >= self.end_datetime:
        raise ValidationError("Start time must be before end time.")

    # Coach must teach this skill
    if self.coach_id and self.skill_id:
        if not self.coach.teaches.filter(pk=self.skill_id).exists():
            raise ValidationError("You can only create sessions for skills you teach.")

    # In-person slots must have an area
    if self.mode == self.Mode.IN_PERSON and self.area is None:
        raise ValidationError("In-person sessions must include an area for filtering.")

    # Sports must be in-person with an Eircode
    if self.skill_id and self.skill.category.name.lower() == "sports":
        if self.mode != self.Mode.IN_PERSON:
            raise ValidationError("Sports sessions must be in-person.")
        if not self.venue_eircode:
            raise ValidationError("Sports sessions require a location Eircode.")

    # No overlapping slots for the same coach
    overlap = SessionSlot.objects.filter(
        coach=self.coach,
        status__in=[self.Status.AVAILABLE, self.Status.BOOKED],
        start_datetime__lt=self.end_datetime,
        end_datetime__gt=self.start_datetime,
    ).exclude(pk=self.pk).exists()

    if overlap:
        raise ValidationError("This slot overlaps with another slot you already created.")
```

Figure 36: Slot Validation Rules

3.11.3 User Model — Custom User Account Structure

The system uses a customised user model to manage different types of accounts within the platform. This model allows the system to distinguish between students, parents, and coaches while using the secure authentication features provided by the Django framework.

```
class User(AbstractUser):

    # Two possible roles for any user
    class Role(models.TextChoices):
        STUDENT = "STUDENT", "Student/Parent"
        COACH   = "COACH",   "Coach/Teacher"

    class Gender(models.TextChoices):
        MALE       = "MALE",       "Male"
        FEMALE     = "FEMALE",     "Female"
        NON_BINARY = "NON_BINARY", "Non-binary"
        PREFER_NOT = "PREFER_NOT", "Prefer not to say"

    role    = models.CharField(max_length=20, choices=Role.choices, default=Role.STUDENT)
    forename        = models.CharField(max_length=80, blank=True)
    surname         = models.CharField(max_length=80, blank=True)
    dob             = models.DateField(null=True, blank=True)
    address         = models.CharField(max_length=255, blank=True)
    gender          = models.CharField(max_length=20, choices=Gender.choices, blank=True)
    bio             = models.TextField(blank=True)
    profile_picture = models.ImageField(upload_to="profiles/", blank=True, null=True)

    def full_name(self):
        # Returns "First Last", or just the username if no name is set
        name = f"{self.forename} {self.surname}".strip()
        return name if name else self.username
```

Figure 37: Custom User Account Structure

3.11.4 Recurring Slot Generation — Automated Availability Creation

The recurring slot generation feature allows coaches to set their availability once and have the system automatically create multiple future session slots. This reduces the need for manual entry and helps coaches manage their schedules more efficiently.

When recurring availability is created, the system calculates the correct dates for each week and generates individual session slots using the coach's selected settings. Each generated slot is checked to ensure it does not conflict with existing bookings. If a conflict occurs, the system skips the invalid slot and continues creating the remaining sessions. At the end of the process, the coach receives confirmation showing how many session slots were successfully created.

```
elif action == "create_recurring": ### Recurring session creation
    recurring_form = RecurringAvailabilityForm(request.POST, coach_profile=coach)
    if recurring_form.is_valid():
        d          = recurring_form.cleaned_data
        target_dow = int(d["day_of_week"])
        duration   = datetime.timedelta(minutes=int(d["slot_duration_minutes"]))
        today      = datetime.date.today()
        # Work out days until the next occurrence of the chosen weekday
        days_ahead = (target_dow - today.weekday()) % 7 or 7
        first_date = today + datetime.timedelta(days=days_ahead)
        created    = 0

        # Generate one slot per week for the requested number of weeks
        for week in range(int(d["weeks_ahead"])):
            slot_date = first_date + datetime.timedelta(weeks=week)
            start_dt  = timezone.make_aware(datetime.datetime.combine(slot_date, d["start_time"]))
            slot = SessionSlot(
                coach=coach, skill=d["skill"], mode=d["mode"],
                area=d["area"], venue_eircode=d["venue_eircode"],
                start_datetime=start_dt, end_datetime=start_dt + duration,
            )
            try:
                slot.full_clean()
                slot.save()
                created += 1
            except ValidationError:
                pass  # skip slots that fail validation (e.g. overlaps)

        if created:
            messages.success(request, f"{created} slot(s) created.")
        else:
            messages.error(request, "No slots created — check for overlaps.")
        return redirect("coach_dashboard")
    messages.error(request, "Fix the errors below.")
```

Figure 38: Automated Availability Creation

3.11.5 Calendar Implementation — Displaying Available Sessions

The system uses an interactive calendar to display available session times for each coach. When the calendar page loads, the system prepares the session data and sends it to the user's browser in a format that can be displayed visually.

Each session is shown as a calendar entry with its time, booking link, and colour-coded category. For example, in-person sessions appear in one colour, while online sessions appear in another. This visual approach helps users quickly identify available sessions and select suitable booking times.

```
# Build the list of events for FullCalendar
calendar_events = []
for slot in slots:
    label, bg = _slot_label_and_colour(slot, coach.category.name)
    area_str = slot.area.name if slot.area else ""

    calendar_events.append({
        "id":              slot.id,
        "title":           label,
        "start":           slot.start_datetime.isoformat(),
        "end":             slot.end_datetime.isoformat(),
        "url":             f"/slot/{slot.id}/book/",
        "backgroundColor": bg,
        "borderColor":     "transparent",
        "textColor":       "#ffffff",
        "extendedProps": {
            "mode":   slot.get_mode_display(),
            "area":   f"{area_str} ({slot.venue_eircode})" if slot.venue_eircode else area_str,
            "skill":  slot.skill.name,
            "slotId": slot.id,
        },
    })
```

Figure 39: Displaying Available Sessions

3.11.6 Google Maps Integration — Location Selection for In-Person Sessions

The platform includes an address lookup feature that helps users enter their address to confirm the location for the lesson. As the user begins typing an address, the system suggests matching locations within Ireland. Once an address is selected, the system records the location details automatically. These details are stored with the booking and used to display a map showing the lesson location.

```javascript
function initMap() {
    const input    = document.getElementById('{{ form.student_location.id_for_label }}');
    const latField = document.getElementById('{{ form.student_lat.id_for_label }}');
    const lngField = document.getElementById('{{ form.student_lng.id_for_label }}');
    const mapDiv   = document.getElementById('map-preview');
    const mapLabel = document.getElementById('map-label');

    // Restrict suggestions to Ireland
    const options = {
        componentRestrictions: { country: "ie" },
        fields: ["formatted_address", "geometry"],
    };

    const autocomplete = new google.maps.places.Autocomplete(input, options);

    let map = null;
    let marker = null;

    autocomplete.addListener("place_changed", function () {
        const place = autocomplete.getPlace();

        if (!place.geometry) return;

        const lat = place.geometry.location.lat();
        const lng = place.geometry.location.lng();

        // Store coords in hidden fields so Django saves them
        latField.value = lat;
        lngField.value = lng;

        // Show the map
        mapDiv.style.display = "block";
        mapLabel.style.display = "block";

        if (!map) {
            map = new google.maps.Map(mapDiv, {
                zoom: 15,
                center: { lat, lng },
                mapTypeControl: false,
                streetViewControl: false,
                fullscreenControl: false,
            });
            marker = new google.maps.Marker({
                position: { lat, lng },
                map: map,
                title: place.formatted_address,
            });
        } else {
            // Update existing map and marker
            map.setCenter({ lat, lng });
            marker.setPosition({ lat, lng });
        }
    });
}
```

Figure 40: Location selection code for In-Person lessons

3.12 Interface Rational

The interface design of the LevelUp! platform focused on simplicity, clarity, and ease of navigation for both instructors and users searching for lessons. Two key areas of the system were given particular attention during development: the Coach Dashboard and the Find Lessons page, as these represent the most frequently used parts of the platform.

The Coach Dashboard was designed to provide a clear and organised display of all relevant information required by instructors in a single location. This includes session creation, booking requests, and upcoming lessons. Presenting this information on one screen reduces the need for instructors to move between multiple pages and helps them manage their schedules more efficiently. The layout prioritises visibility of key actions such as creating session slots and responding to booking requests.

The Find Lessons page was designed to be simple and easy to navigate, allowing users to quickly locate suitable instructors or coaches. Filters were placed prominently on the page so users can refine their search by category, skill, lesson mode, and location. This structure supports efficient decision-making and helps users compare available options without confusion.

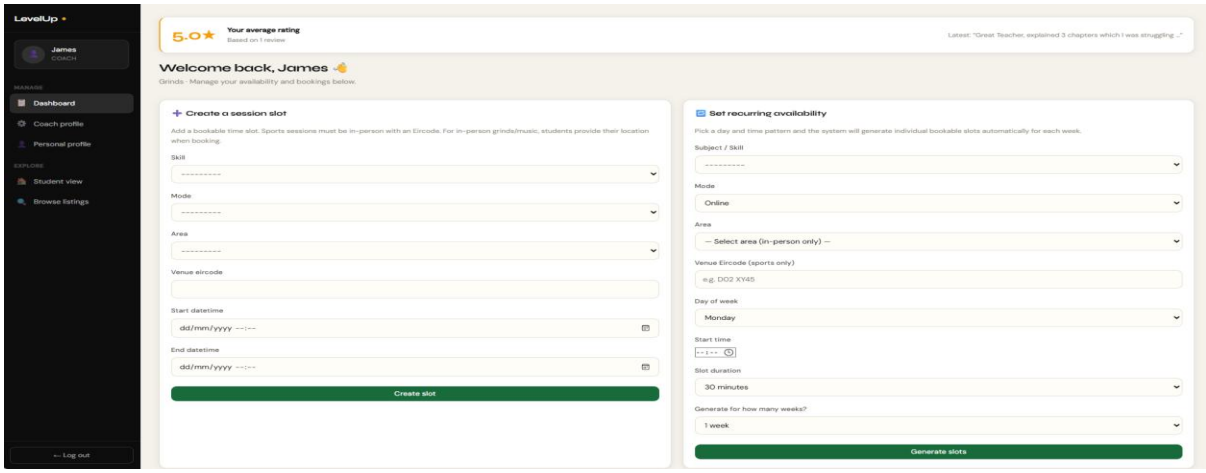

Figure 41: Coach Dashboard

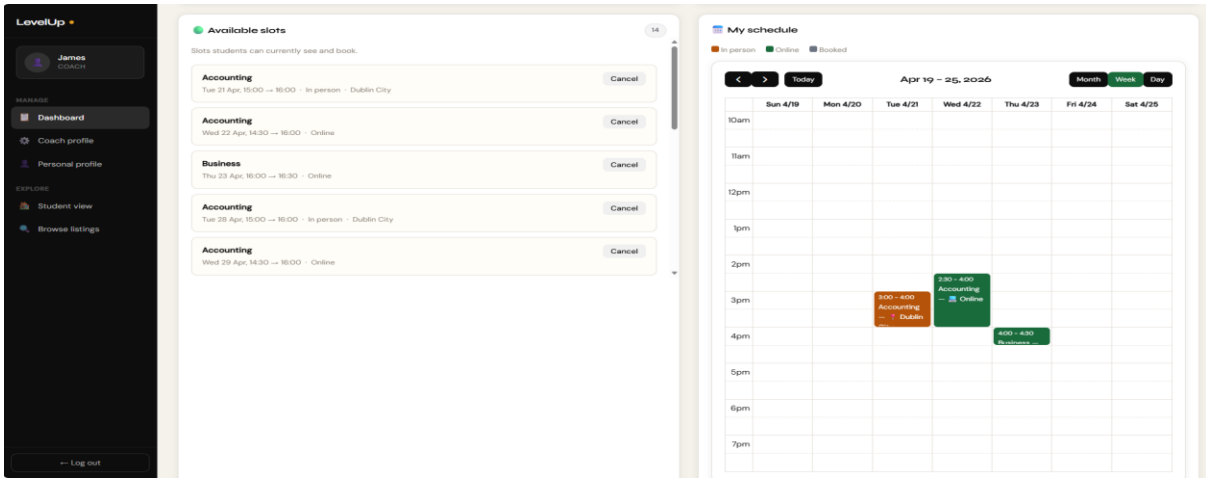

Figure 42:Coach Dashboard Continued

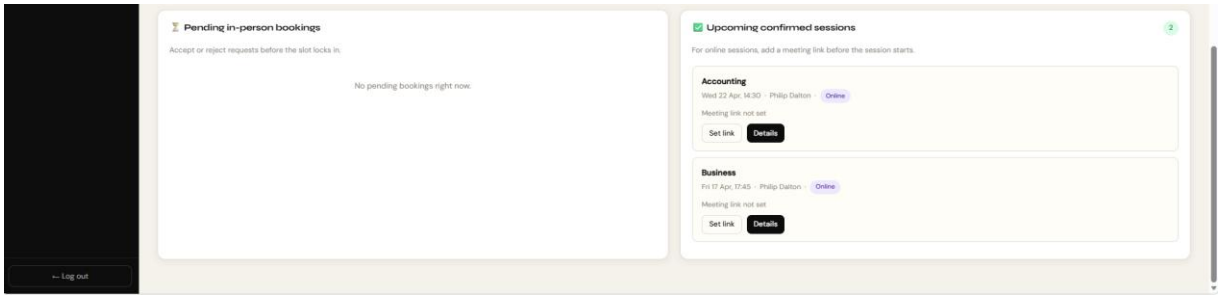

Figure 43: Coach Dashboard Continued

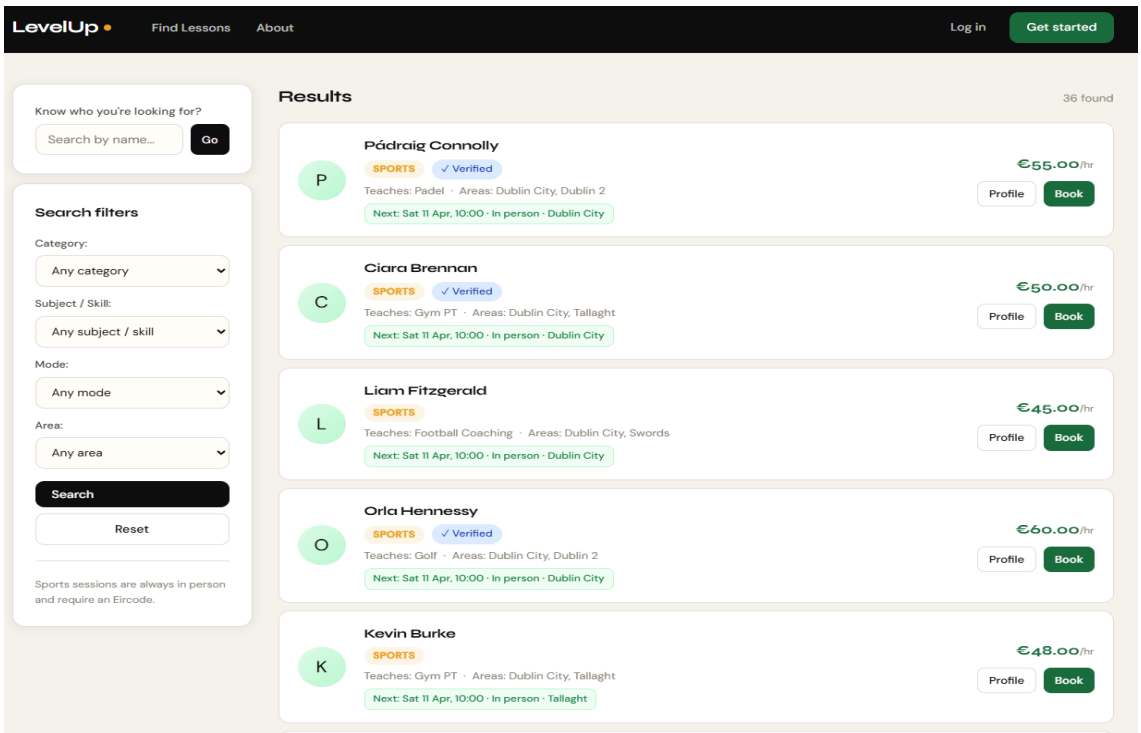

Figure 44: Find Lessons Page

3.13 User Testing

3.13.1 Methodology

User testing was conducted to evaluate the usability, functionality, and overall experience of the LevelUp! platform. The primary objective was to assess whether users could successfully complete core tasks including creating an account and booking a lesson, without assistance from the development team.

The platform interface was designed following established UX best practices to ensure clarity and accessibility across all user types [15] . A small but representative sample of participants was selected, drawing on research which suggests that five to eight users will uncover approximately 85% of a product's usability issues [16][17]. Eight participants were recruited to represent each of the platform's key user groups: two teachers, two parents, three students, and one coach.

Participants were asked to complete a defined set of tasks while thinking aloud and verbalising their thoughts in real time. This approach, known as the think-aloud protocol [18], provides immediate and unfiltered feedback on how users interpret and interact with the system. Facilitators observed without intervening unless the participant was entirely unable to proceed, ensuring the reliability and independence of the findings.

3.13.2 Key Findings and Changes Made

User feedback produced several actionable insights that were directly incorporated into the platform. These are described in the table below.

#	User Feedback	Implementation Decision
1	Users required flexibility in lesson delivery format	Online and in-person modes introduced; mode displayed directly on each calendar slot for easy filtering
2	Parents were uncertain how their child's details would be managed	Child profile feature introduced, allowing parents to create and manage under-18 profiles within their own account
3	Availability was not immediately clear from the scheduling interface	FullCalendar implemented with colour-coded slots displaying skill, mode, and area on each event face, eliminating the need to click through individual slots
4	Booking status was unclear after a booking had been made	Status indicators added to the booking detail page, distinguishing between pending, confirmed, rejected, and cancelled states
5	Returning users had no way to search for a previously used coach	Search functionality added to the Find Lessons page

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5 Appendix

5.1 Appendix A - Team CVs

Dylan Doyle

B.Sc. Computing for Business

EDUCATION

BSc Computing for Business
Dublin City University
2022 – Present

Leaving Certificate
St. Paul's College, Raheny
2016 – 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Python & Django
- HTML, CSS & JavaScript
- Java & PHP/MySQL
- Linux / Linux Shell / Windows
- Excel, PowerPoint & Canva
- Database Design (MySQL)

SOFT SKILLS

- Analytical & Problem Solving
- Team Collaboration
- Strong Communication
- Time Management
- Customer Service

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Clontarf Soccer FC Member
- Football Player of the Year – St. Paul's (2019/2021/2022)
- Avid Golfer
- Full Driving Licence (2022)
- Cyber Security Academy, Trinity College – Cryptography, Authentication & Investigation
- Peter McVerry Charity TY Placement
- Belgrove Boys N.S. TY Placement

PROFILE

Final-year Computing for Business student at DCU with a strong foundation in business computing complimented by a keen analytical mindset and problem solving skills. Experienced in professional business analysis through an AIG internship, with practical exposure to vulnerability management, compliance documentation, and operational support. Combines technical capability with excellent communication skills and a strong team-oriented background.

EXPERIENCE

Business Analyst Intern *Feb 2025 – Aug 2025*
American International Group (AIG)

- Conducted daily vulnerability scans and participated in team huddle meetings
- Assessed and reviewed updated runbooks, SPC's DUC and Interfaces documents
- Supported the App Management Team across operational and compliance activities

Retail Assistant *Jul 2023 – Feb 2025*
Mace Retail Shop

- Delivered customer service, payment management and stock control
- Trained new staff members and managed day-end reconciliation
- Handled shop opening and closing procedures

Warehouse Assistant *Jul 2022 – Sep 2022*
Leydens Wholesale Cash & Carry

- Assisted customers and operated the checkout using the Leydens sales app
- Processed orders and monitored stock levels throughout the warehouse

James Dalton

B.Sc. Computing for Business

EDUCATION

BSc Computing for Business
Dublin City University
2022 – Present

Leaving Certificate
St. Paul's College, Raheny
2016 – 2022

SKILLS

- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Django & Python
- Backend CMS (Umbraco)
- Full Drivers Licence
- Open & Clear Communicator
- Strong Work Ethic
- Team Collaboration
- Problem Solving
- Efficient Multitasker

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Captain, Gaelic Team
- 4× Olympic Triathlon Completed
- GAA Juvenile Referee

PROFILE

Final-year Computing for Business student at DCU with hands-on frontend development experience gained through an industry internship and a fully functional final-year project. Proven ability to work across technical and customer-facing roles, combining strong communication skills with a disciplined, team-oriented approach.

EXPERIENCE

Web Designer (Internship) *Jan 2025 – Jul 2025*
Progress Systems Ltd.

- Contributed to the design and maintenance of multiple live credit union websites
- Built and updated websites in production using CSS, HTML and Umbraco CMS
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to implement design improvements
- Designed and launched a responsive site for Muckamore Credit Union
- Conducted website testing and troubleshooting to improve user experience

Bar Staff *May 2022 – Present*
Aramark – Croke Park

- Maintained high standards of cleanliness in compliance with health and safety regulations
- Mixed and served drinks for multiple guests simultaneously in a high-volume venue
- Kept bar areas well-stocked throughout each shift

Event Staff *Mar 2018 – Present*
Aviva Stadium, Dublin

- Collected payments using cash & POS systems with zero errors
- Distributed event information and marketing materials to attendees

Juvenile Referee *May 2021 – Present*
GAA – Clontarf/Raheny, Dublin

- Managed multidisciplinary teams of match officials, providing clear verbal communication
- Officiated sporting events and athletic competitions across Dublin

Retail Assistant *Nov 2022 – Dec 2024*
Nolan's Supermarket, Clontarf

- Managed stock levels, completed weekly stock takes and maintained store standards

Construction Labourer *Jun 2019 – Aug 2025*
Kyne Construction, Dublin

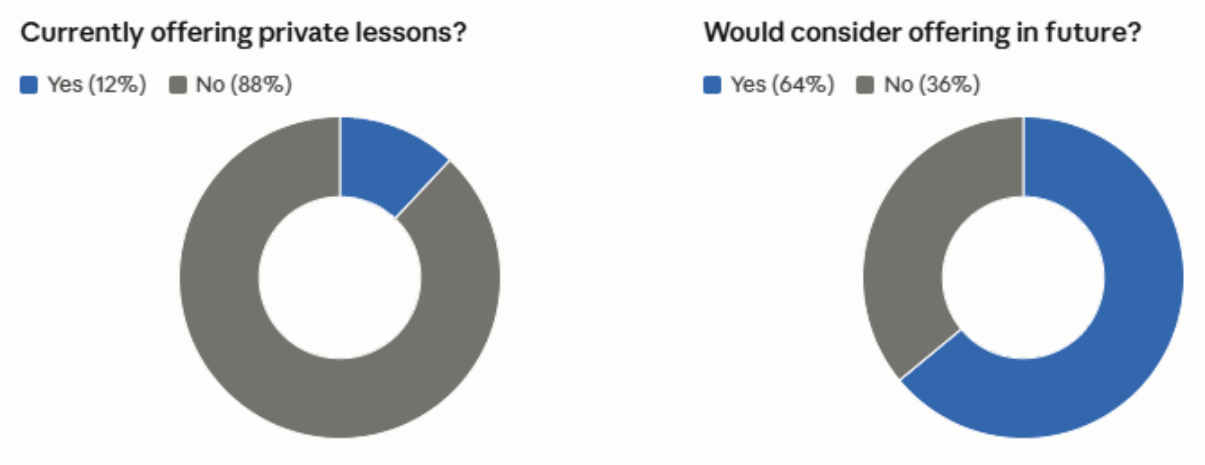
- Conducted site cleans, risk assessments and hazard removal
- Laid concrete for foundations, floors and beams to deadlines

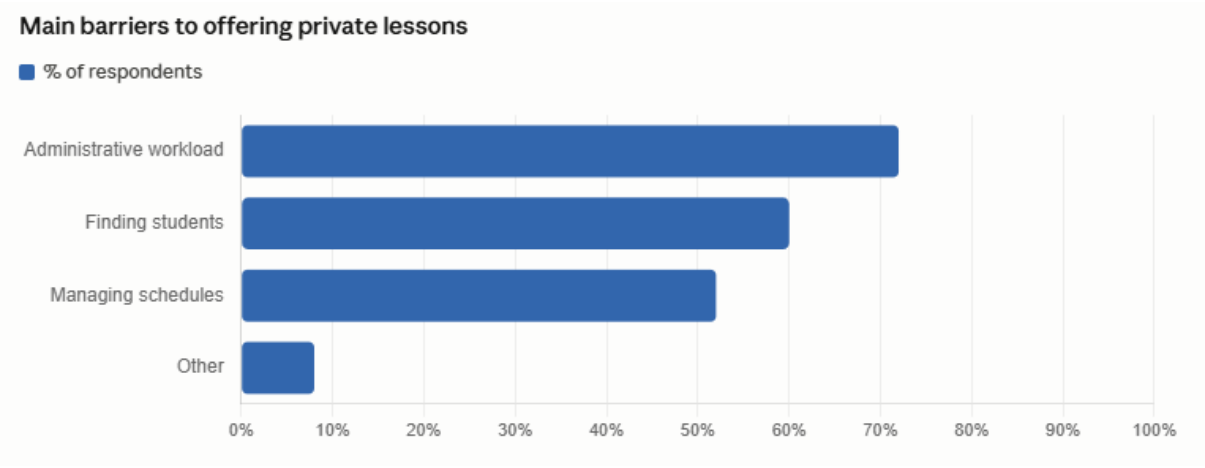
5.2 Appendix B - Primary Research Survey Questions

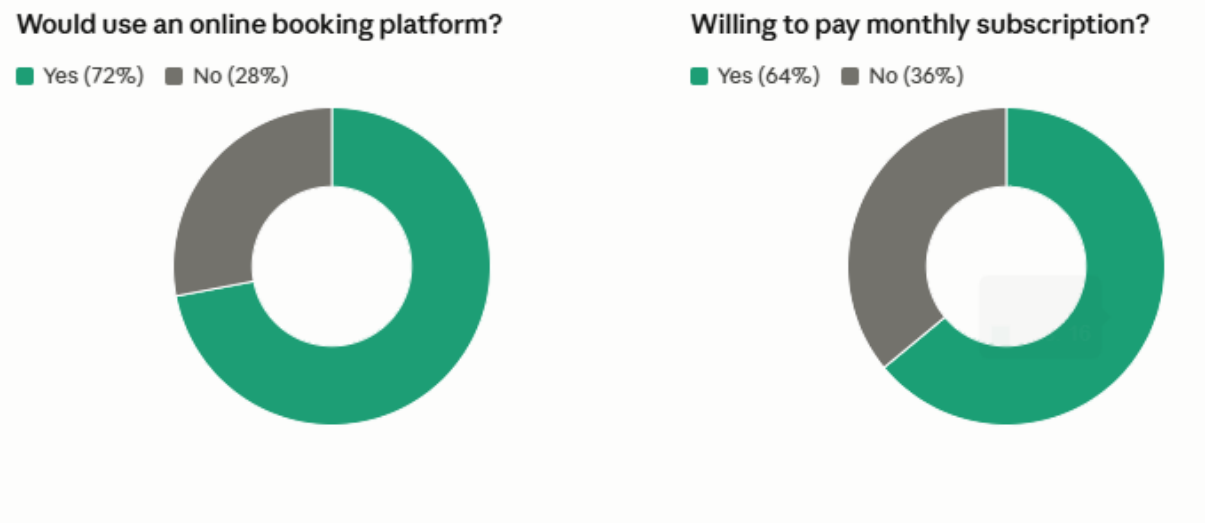
Instructors were asked the following questions about their experience with grinds in Ireland. A sample of 25 was selected from schools, student networking including peers studying at third level and from advertisements of grind services on local notice boards.

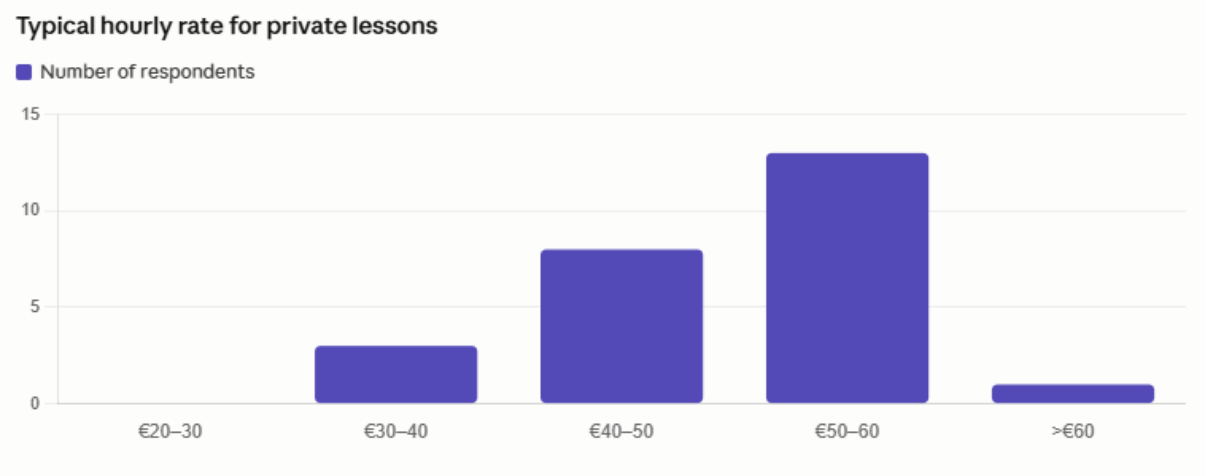
Question	Sample	Result
Do you currently offer private grinds outside of your main employment?	25	Yes – 3 No – 22
Would you consider offering private lessons in the future?	25	Yes – 16 No – 9
What are the main barriers preventing you from offering private lessons?	25	Finding students - 60% (15) Managing Schedules and Availability - 52% (13) Administrative Workload - 72% (18) Other (please specify) - 8% (2) - Payment Handling (1) - Concerns about upfront costs (1)
Would you use an online platform that automatically handled booking and scheduling for your lessons?	25	Yes – 18 No – 7
How much would you typically charge per hour for private lessons? (Select all that apply)	25	€20-€30 - 0 €30-€40 - 3 €40-€50 - 8 €50-€60 - 13 More than €60 - 1
Would you be willing to pay a Month for a subscription to access a professional booking platform that provides features such as calendar scheduling and booking management.	25	Yes – 16 No - 9
Have you heard of any existing platform used for booking private lessons or coaching services? (Select all that apply)	25	SuperProf – 12% (3) TutorFull – 24% (6) Other – WhatsApp Groups 60% (15) None - 8% (2)

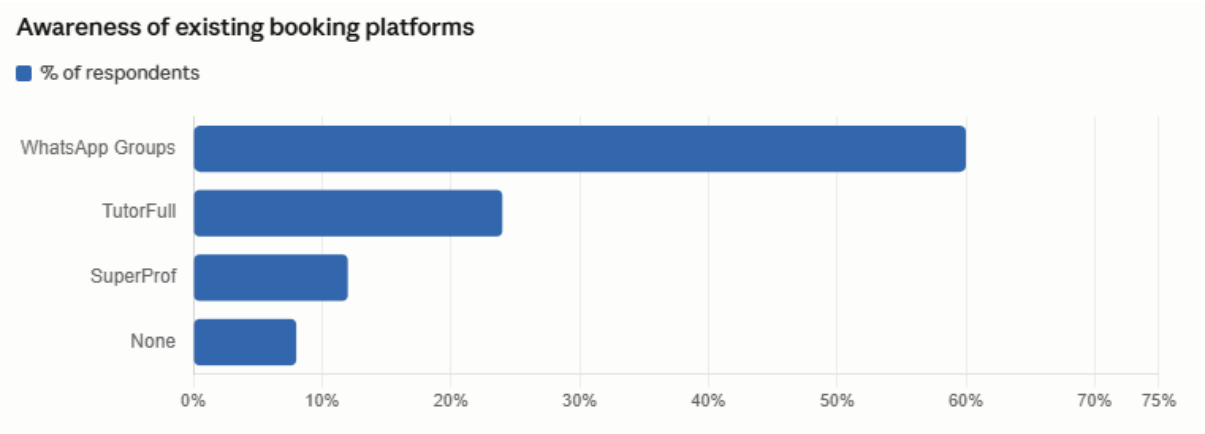
5.2.1 Primary Research Results








Typical hourly rate for private lessons
Number of respondents
15
10
5
0
€20–30
€30–40
€40–50
€50–60
>€60


Awareness of existing booking platforms
% of respondents
WhatsApp Groups
TutorFull
SuperProf
None
0%
10%
20%
30%
40%
50%
60%
70%
75%

5.3 Appendix C - Individual Development Logs

Dylan Doyle - Weekly Log: [LINK]

James Dalton - Weekly Log: [LINK]

5.4 Appendix D - GitLab Repository

GitLab Repo link: https://gitlab.computing.dcu.ie/doyled66/2026-csc1180-dylandoyle-jamesdalton/-/tree/master

5.5 Appendix E - User Testing

5.5.1 User Testing Questions

Participants were asked the following questions during testing to assess their understanding of the platform and identify potential usability issues:

1. When first brought to the landing page, what do you think this website does?
2. Were you able to book a grind for a chosen subject that fits your own criteria?
3. Were you able to book a lesson for a chosen sport that fits your own criteria?
4. Were you able to create a student or coach account successfully?
5. Was there anything confusing or unclear while using the website?
6. Were there any points where you did not know what to do next?
7. Would you trust this website to manage bookings or personal information?
8. Did anything slow you down while completing your tasks?
9. If you could change anything about the website, what would it be?

These questions were designed to evaluate ease of use, clarity of navigation, and overall user confidence when interacting with the platform.

5.5.2 User Interface Design Considerations

The design of the LevelUp! platform was evaluated using recognised user experience (UX) design principles to ensure the interface supports efficient and intuitive interaction. The following usability guidelines were used as a reference framework during testing [15].

Key UX Design Principles Applied

Users should receive adequate feedback when they perform an action.
For example, the system provides confirmation messages when bookings are successfully created or cancelled.

Users should always be aware of the consequences of their actions and be able to easily undo mistakes.
Clear confirmation steps and cancellation options were included to reduce user errors.

Error messages should be easy to understand and clearly explain what the problem is.
The platform displays simple, user-friendly error messages when invalid input or booking conflicts occur.

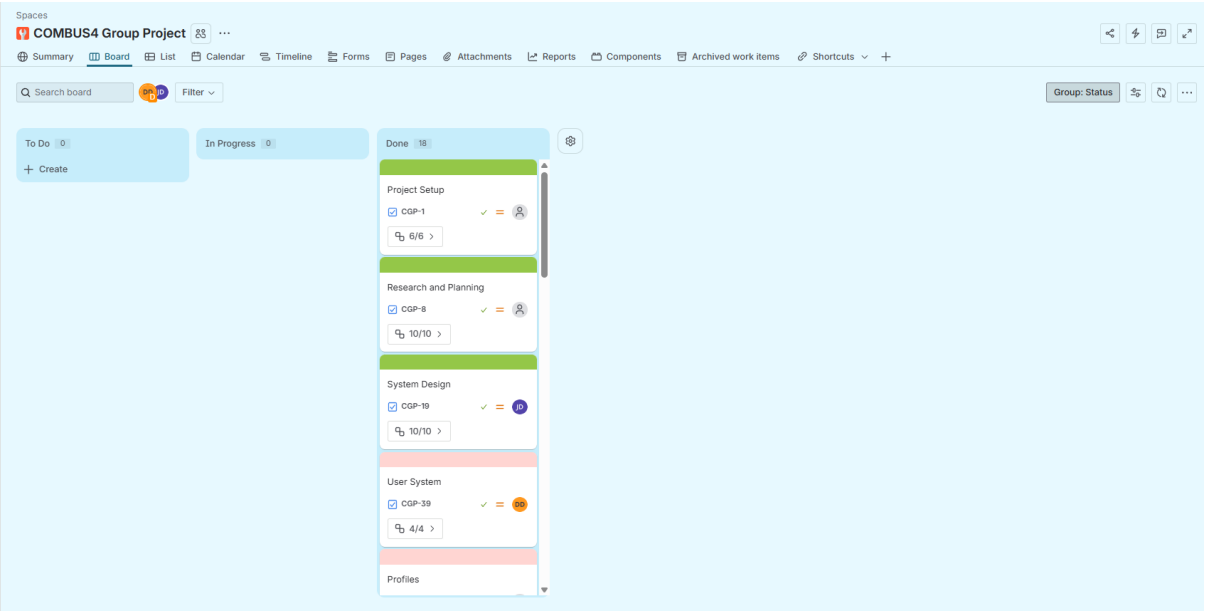
User interface elements should remain consistent throughout the application in both appearance and functionality.
Buttons, forms, and navigation menus follow a consistent layout across all pages.

The application should be flexible enough to support both experienced and inexperienced users while maintaining efficiency.
The system uses straightforward navigation and visual scheduling tools to accommodate users with varying levels of technical experience.

Help and guidance should be accessible and focused on the task being performed.
Clear instructions and prompts are displayed within forms and booking workflows to guide users through each step.

5.6 Appendix F - Jira

https://combus4groupproject.atlassian.net/jira/core/projects/CGP/board?filter=&groupBy=status



5.7 Acknowledgement and Thanks

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to our project supervisor, Dr. John McKenna, for his guidance, support, and encouragement throughout the development of this project. John's feedback and expertise were invaluable in shaping both the direction and quality of our work, and his availability and constructive input at each stage of the process made a significant contribution to the final outcome.